International AI Track | Technical Document

Required material for the International AI Track. Please complete this document in English.

Team name	ISMOGGER
Competition track	International AI Track — Topic E: SME Finance Copilot
Submission date	20 October 2026

FLOW is a working-capital agent for a small supplier. When a large buyer asks for better payment terms, FLOW works out what the request would cost the supplier in cash and borrowing, answers within limits the owner has signed, and arranges and follows the funding the answer needs.

- **Who it is for.** The owner of a supplier business with roughly 20 to 100 staff, 10 to 40 business buyers, one bank credit line and no finance team, who sells on credit to buyers larger than itself.
- **The decision it improves.** Whether to grant a buyer's request for longer payment terms, an early-payment discount or a rebate (trade credit the supplier gives), and how to fund what that costs (credit the supplier must then take). Today the owner usually decides the first alone, from a chat message, and discovers the second later.
- **Why it matters financially.** On the demo company's books, a buyer asks for 60-day terms instead of 45, 1.2% off for paying one invoice early and a 1% rebate. Priced at the supplier's own cost of borrowing, accepting as asked gives away **CNY 33,366.92**: a ¥5,040 discount now and ¥28,326.92 of future concessions over the next 365 days, 5.7 times the owner's limit for such promises. It also takes cash below the owner's safety reserve from day 47.
- **What FLOW does today.** It reads the request and the supplier's contracts; projects daily cash, debt and loan covenants; returns a verdict with its reason, formula and priced counter-offers; finds a funding plan among the owner's committed facilities; asks the owner for anything it may not do alone; follows the deal through receipts and reconciliation; and answers the owner's questions from the books, in English and Chinese.
- **Where AI contributes.** A language model assists in three places only: **reading** buyer messages, term sheets, contracts and lender agreements into typed terms, each tied to the words it came from; **classifying** an owner's chat request that the deterministic parser cannot read, into one intent from a closed list; and **routing** an owner's question to at most three of 40 read-only tools. Deterministic code computes every figure, verdict and reply. In the demo, the tests and every offline result, a deterministic rules grammar does the reading; a model is called only in live mode.
- **What limits its authority.** An owner-signed mandate (Ed25519) sets the reserve, the cap on future concessions, the covenants and the rate above which borrowing needs approval. The executor decides each operation's tier from the operation itself: **Tier 1** runs inside the mandate without an owner step, **Tier 2** waits for the owner's approval, **Tier 3** (personal guarantees, collateral, equity, changing the mandate) is refused for everyone, the owner included. No operation has a payee or account field.
- **The evidence.** Table 1, with each result's evidence class and denominator; section 03 explains them.
- **What is simulated, and what is incomplete.** Buyers, lenders, the bank feed and the clock are simulated. No real money moves and no bank, lender or payment API is called. FLOW runs as a local simulation; nothing in this document comes from a deployed system. FLOW accepts only 3 of 14 acceptable buyer offers on its own, does not read scanned or photographed contracts (no OCR), and its live-model results are single runs.

All amounts are Chinese yuan (CNY, written ¥) on synthetic books. "Day 0" is 1 October 2026, the demo books' opening date.

Table 1. FLOW at a glance. Engine and agent figures: dev `975e082f` (17 Oct 2026), re-run offline on `571ea64f` (18 Oct) with the same results. Owner-question and held-out figures: `571ea64f`, 18 Oct. Live figures: the dates given. Table 14 gives each source.

What	Result	Evidence class
Decisions	Six verdicts (accept, counter, reject, no deal, needs the owner, no verdict), each with the failing rule, the figures, its formula and the source words	Code
Engine correctness	67 of 67 golden financial values exact to the fen against an independently written oracle (same specification, same team); covenant and capex values 27 of 27	Tests
Funding router	Within ¥1 of a bounded brute-force search on 26 of 26 test scenarios; 19 plans run today, 6 are labelled "cannot run today", and in 1 scenario no admissible plan exists and the router says so	Tests
Safety of autonomy	On 115 held-out buyer messages FLOW accepted 3 on its own, all correctly. Before the coverage proof (ADR-0005), the first runs on the same sets accepted 6 misread messages; that is why autonomy now requires proof	Unseen first runs, then tuned
Usefulness	57 of 115 messages handled with no owner step (54 counters or declines, 3 accepts). Only 3 of the 14 genuinely acceptable offers are accepted alone; the other 11 wait for one owner review (Table 8)	Tuned
Reading contracts	75% of key fields right on 17 unseen Chinese contracts with a text layer (45% over all 30, because 13 scans and photos are refused)	Unseen, recorded model replay
Owner questions	Of 427 bank questions the books can answer, 228 answered from the books, 45 partly, 0 wrong (the bank the answers were built against). On 142 held-out everyday wordings, 127 reach the right answer (89%) and 3 a wrong topic (2%)	Tuned; held-out
Live model	One live DeepSeek run per component: buyer messages 42 of 63 verdicts, no wrong accept (1 Oct); the question router answered 33 of the 63 questions that reached it on 18 Oct, 22 fully right by one reviewer's reading	Live, single runs
Security	279 stored attack cases (128 through the API, 151 through chat): none violated the defined harm oracles in the specified offline runs (rules path and a scripted hostile model; no real model read an attack). Internal review by the team's Security Lead, an AI agent; not external assurance (section 04)	Tests
Task completion	49 of 49 scripted conversations, written by the team, pass their own checks (88 turns); the 17-step demo walk ends with a 14-entry hash chain that verifies, and a tampered copy is rejected	Scripted tasks, simulated environment
Product	Setup, a daily view, documents, customers, deals, money over time, approvals, a chat, what-if and strategy views, capex and an evidence export (Table 3), in English and Chinese	Code, browser tests
Tests	The API, web-unit and browser suites pass on the builds named in Table 14. A count measures the size of a suite, not correctness	Tests

How to read this document. Section 01 follows one supplier through FLOW and states what is new. Section 02 explains how FLOW is built and where a model is used. Section 03 explains how the agent understands, plans and acts, the algorithms, and how well it works, including where it falls short. Section 04 covers security and section 05 running, testing and known limits; the appendices follow section 05. Every number is synthetic and was measured on the build named beside it. The submission build adds the Ask FLOW and error-handling changes described in sections 02 and 03 after the last measured build.

01 Project Overview

- Problem, target users and selected topic

Selected topic. International AI Track, Topic E: SME Finance Copilot, under the theme "AI as a Financial Participant". FLOW covers each part of the topic's scope: **financing-option matching** (the funding router

compares the owner's facilities), **cash-flow management and alerts** (a daily cash forecast and alerts that speak first), **business financial analysis** (covenants, customer exposure, capex screening), **reconciliation** (each receipt matched against what was promised) and **operational recommendations** (verdicts, priced counter-offers and funding plans).

The problem. Large buyers now negotiate payment terms with software. Procurement agents ask suppliers for longer terms, early-payment discounts and rebates "within parameters you define" (Pactum's public material describes this). Lenders approve small-business credit by model in seconds (MYbank, WeBank). The supplier in the middle usually has neither. An owner reads a WeChat message at night and decides alone whether to accept 60-day terms, and separately, often later, whether to borrow to survive them.

The insight behind FLOW: a longer payment term is a loan from the supplier to the buyer. It moves no money today, so spending limits, approval rules and wallet controls let it through. But the supplier has to fund the gap, usually by borrowing. On the demo company, whose largest buyer, Foshan Home Retail, receives a ¥420,000 invoice every 30 days on 45-day terms, the buyer's request (EX01) asks for three things:

- **Terms from 45 to 60 days on every future invoice.** That ties up ¥210,000 more in receivables on average for as long as the terms last (¥420,000 for 15 days in every 30). Priced at 10.84% a year, the all-in rate of invoice financing, the cheapest committed source that the credit line's 30-day clean-down rule allows, each invoice's 15 extra days cost ¥1,871.30, which is **¥24,326.92 over the 13 invoices issued in the next 365 days**. (10.84% is a tariff equivalent; an advance held for less than a whole 30-day period costs more.)
- **A 1.2% discount for paying the current ¥420,000 invoice early:** ¥5,040, given up now.
- **A 1% rebate on next quarter's expected ¥400,000 of orders,** counted at its maximum, ¥4,000.

The owner sees "60 days instead of 45". FLOW shows that the future concessions alone come to ¥28,326.92, 5.7 times the ¥5,000 cap the owner signed for such promises; that accepting as asked gives away CNY 33,366.92 in all; and that cash would fall below the ¥300,000 reserve on day 47 and stay there until day 61.

Target users. Supplier SMEs with roughly 20 to 100 staff, 10 to 40 business buyers, one bank credit line, at least one term loan, a bookkeeper and no finance team. Typical sectors are light-manufacturing subcontracting, packaging, logistics, maintenance supplies and facility services. This profile is a composite drawn from our specification. In two interviews with real SME owners, one assumed pain point (that the owner phones the bank when cash looks low) was contradicted, so we do not claim it.

- Core value and innovation

What FLOW does for the owner.

1. **Reads the request.** It turns a buyer's message or contract, in Chinese or English, into typed terms, each tied to the exact words it came from.
2. **Prices it in cash.** It projects the supplier's daily cash, debt and future promises with and without the request, and prices every concession at the supplier's own cost of borrowing.
3. **Decides within the owner's limits.** It returns a verdict with the reason and the formula, and drafts priced counter-offers that keep the business safe.
4. **Arranges the money.** It searches the owner's committed facilities for the cheapest plan that keeps cash above the reserve and meets the covenants, and checks the covenants every month.
5. **Follows through.** It watches for late or partial payment, warns the owner first, proposes a fix inside the limits with its cost, and closes the loop when the money lands.

One engine, two jobs. *Terms Guard* controls the credit the supplier gives its buyers through payment terms, discounts and rebates. *Debt Desk* controls the credit the supplier takes from lenders to survive those terms. They share one financial model: a concession is priced at the supplier's real marginal cost of debt, and because Debt Desk knows the funding alternative, FLOW can walk away from a bad deal and still cover the gap.

One supplier's journey, from documents to reconciliation

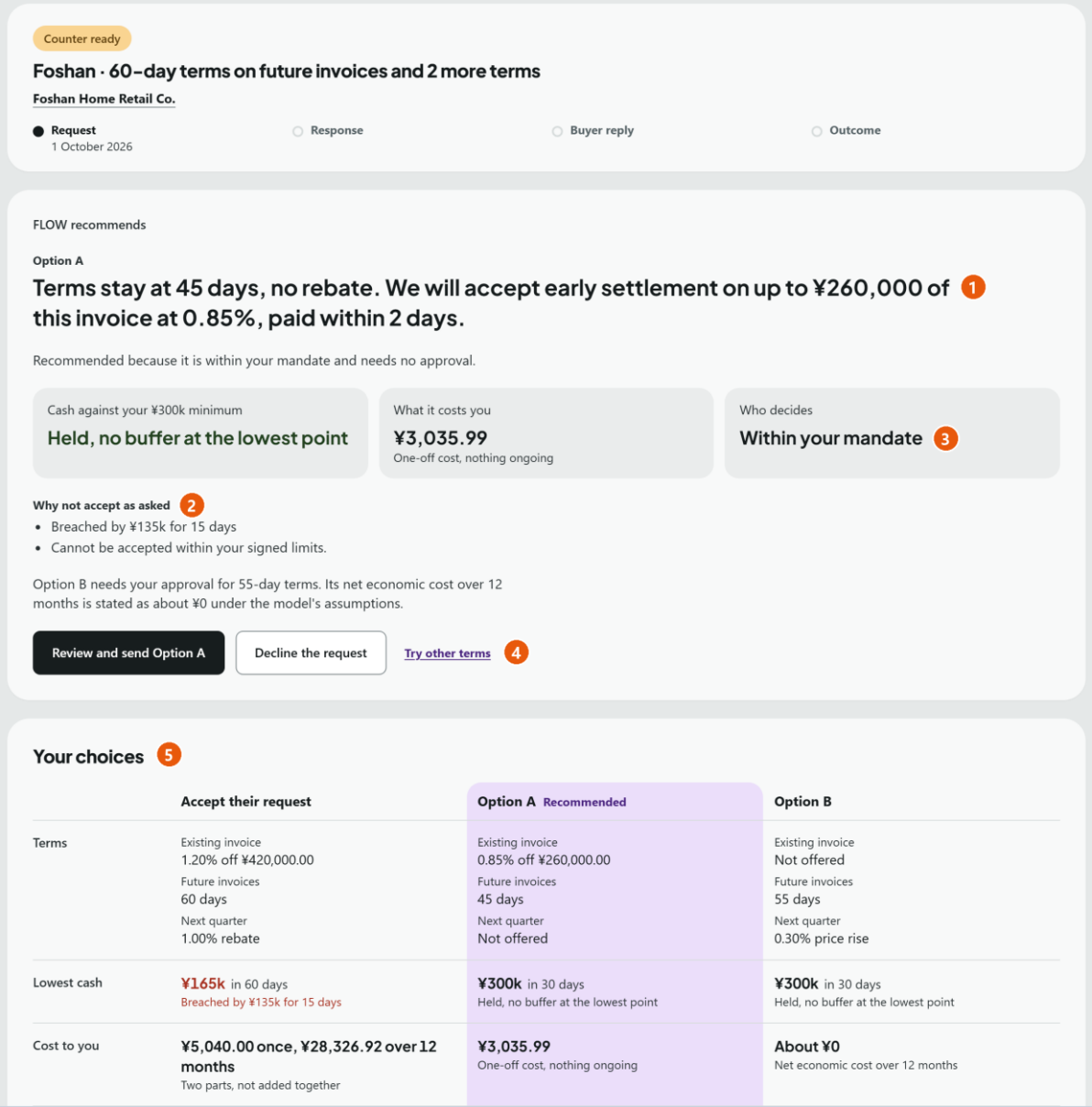
The demo company's story, tied out to the fen by an independent recomputation and by the engine replayed day by day (`scripts/demo_run.py`, 17 steps). Each step says what state the money is in: **proposed** terms

bind nobody; an **authorised** operation has passed the executor's checks; a **recorded** commitment is in the hash-chained log; **settled** means the (simulated) bank feed reported the cash.

1. **Documents.** The owner attaches the supply agreement with Foshan Home Retail. FLOW reads each term beside its clause (price ¥420,000 per batch, 45-day terms) and checks that Foshan is the contract's buyer. Nothing changes in the books until the owner confirms the reading, and a confirmed contract becomes forecast invoices only through a separate, undoable Tier-2 step.
2. **Today's books already need money.** Cash is ¥400,000. Payroll of ¥340,000 (day 12), a supplier payment of ¥120,000 (day 20) and a loan payment of ¥45,000 (day 30) come before Foshan's ¥420,000 invoice is due on day 32. Untouched, cash is below the reserve on days 12 to 31 and reaches −¥105,000 on days 30–31: a need of ¥405,000. FLOW's standing plan draws the credit line (¥150,000 today, ¥841.64 of interest) and finances the Foshan invoice (¥255,000 landing on day 3, ¥2,272.29 for one 30-day period): **¥3,113.93**, with cash exactly at the reserve on day 30.
3. **The request and the verdict (proposed).** Foshan writes: "We'll settle the ¥420k early at 1.2% if you extend our standard terms to 60 days going forward and give us 1% off next quarter." FLOW rejects the package as asked, for four reasons: the concession cap (¥28,326.92 against ¥5,000); the reserve (¥90,040 short on day 47, ¥135,040 at worst on day 60); break-even (1.2% is above 0.8832%, beyond which paying for 30 days' early cash costs more than borrowing it); and price (with the early payment the funding costs ¥6,508.05, without it ¥3,873.58). It drafts two counters. **Option A**: terms stay at 45 days, no rebate, early payment on up to ¥260,000 at 0.85%. **Option B**: 55 days with a 0.30% price rise, a forward gain of ¥162.05 over 13 invoices, but its books still need **CNY 3,706.46** of funding. FLOW recommends Option A (Figure 1).
4. **Agreement (authorised, then recorded).** The owner sends Option A. When the buyer's acceptance arrives, the executor re-checks it on that day's books, binds it to the counter's terms hash and a single-use nonce, and records the commitment. Its funding runs as a Tier-1 operation: the credit line draws ¥147,210 (405,000 − 257,790). Quoted cost: ¥2,210.00 of discount plus ¥825.99 of interest, **¥3,035.99**, ¥77.94 below the standing plan, with no future concession.
5. **First receipt (settled).** On day 2 the bank feed posts ¥257,790.00 (¥260,000 at 0.85%); ¥160,000 of the invoice is still due on day 32. Reconciliation marks the promised early payment as received.
6. **Reality diverges.** On day 25 the bookkeeper schedules a second payroll of ¥200,000 for day 42. On day 32 the ¥160,000 does not arrive. On day 34 FLOW speaks first: on the conservative forecast, which drops the overdue ¥160,000, cash would close day 42 at ¥100,000, ¥200,000 below the reserve. The new payroll causes the breach (with the ¥160,000 paid on time, day 42 would still close at ¥111,964.01); the late payment deepens it.
7. **Approval.** FLOW proposes an advance of ¥200,000 on the invoice due on day 47: ¥1,782.19, because a whole 30-day period is billed for a 10-day hold, which is 32.5% a year. That is above the 15% a year above which FLOW must ask, so "go ahead" **queues it for approval and nothing runs**. The owner's "approve APR-000001" runs it.
8. **Receipts and reconciliation (settled).** The ¥160,000 arrives on day 36 and the advance lands on day 37. After the payroll on day 42 cash is ¥460,000. On day 47 Foshan's next invoice is paid, the advance is repaid from it first, and the credit line is repaid with ¥1,213.17 of interest (47 days instead of the quoted 32). Reconciliation closes the deal, and the record holds 14 hash-chained entries that verify.

Cost item	Quoted on day 0	Actually posted
Early-payment discount	¥2,210.00	¥2,210.00
Credit-line interest	¥825.99 (32 days)	¥1,213.17 (47 days, ¥160,000 paid late)
Advance to cover the new payroll	—	¥1,782.19
Total	**¥3,035.99**	**¥5,205.36**

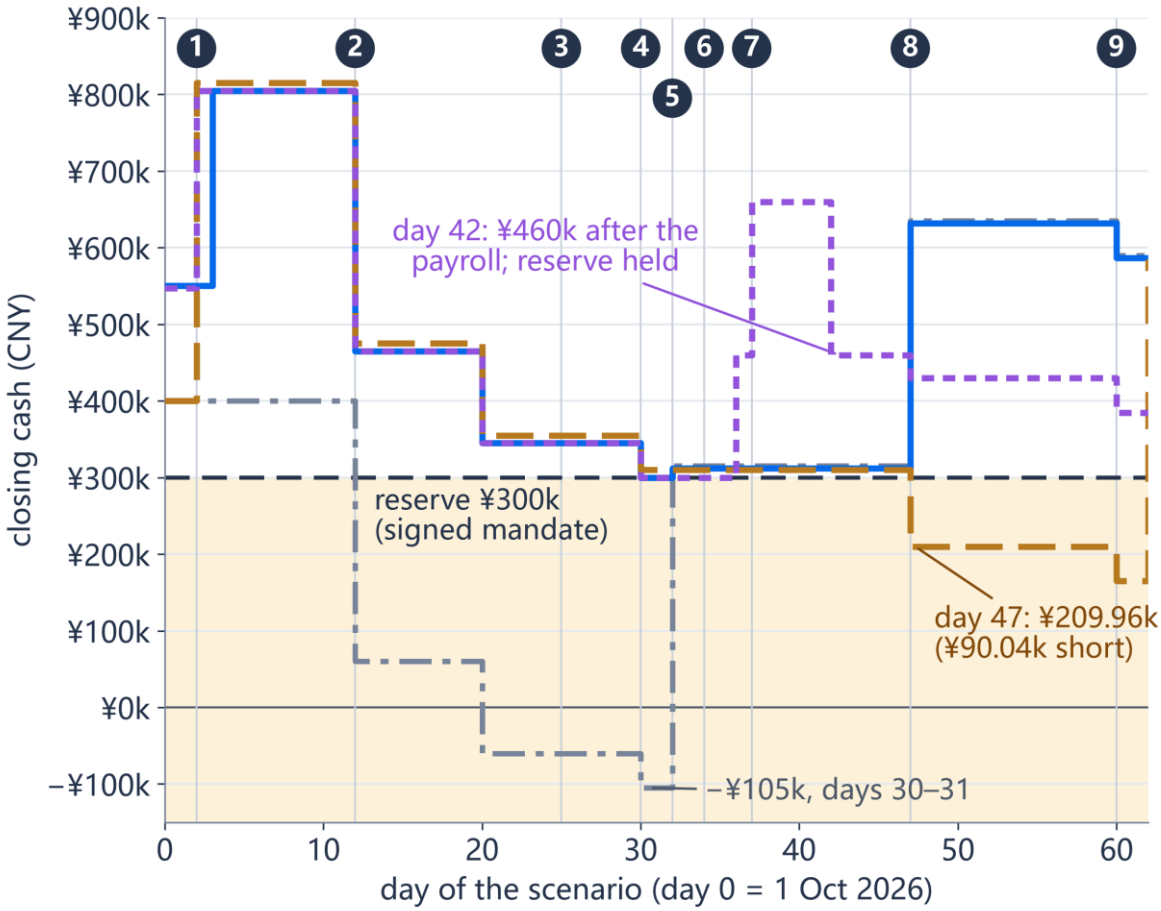
The supplier kept its 45-day terms and gave no rebate. It avoided ¥28,326.92 of future concessions, the ¥5,040 discount and a day-47 breach, and the reserve held on every day (Figure 2). Assumptions: the buyer pays the ¥160,000 on day 36 and the next invoice on its due day 47; the owner approves on day 34; no other cash flow is added.



1. FLOW's verdict: counter with Option A (45 days, early settlement at 0.85%).
2. Why not accept as asked: the reserve is breached by ¥135k for 15 days.
3. Within the signed mandate: no approval needed for Option A.
4. Nothing is sent until the owner reviews and sends it.
5. The priced choices side by side: as asked, Option A, Option B.

Mock mode, golden books (synthetic), docs/techdoc-chat-fixes @ 571ea64f, captured 18 Oct 2026 at 1440×900

Figure 1. Foshan's request after FLOW checked it (web app on recorded mocks, build 571ea64f). (1) The verdict: counter with Option A. (2) Why the request cannot be accepted as asked. (3) Option A is within the signed mandate. (4) Nothing is sent until the owner sends it. (5) The priced choices: Option A, early payment on up to ¥260,000 at 0.85%, costs ¥3,035.99; Option B is 55-day terms with a 0.30% price rise.



Today's books, no new funding
FLOW's standing plan: line ¥150k + invoice financing ¥255k (¥3,113.93)
Buyer's request accepted as asked, no new funding
Option A as the demo runs it: ¥160k paid late, month-2 payroll, ¥200k cure approved by the owner (total cost ¥5,205.36)

1. day 2: buyer pays early (as asked ¥414,960; Option A ¥257,790)
2. day 12: payroll −¥340,000
3. day 25: bookkeeper adds month-2 payroll of ¥200,000 for day 42
4. day 30: loan payment −¥45,000
5. day 32: ¥420,000 invoice due; demo: ¥160,000 of it not paid
6. day 34: FLOW proposes a ¥200,000 advance (¥1,782.19, 32.5% a year); owner approves
7. day 37: the advance lands (the late ¥160,000 arrived on day 36)
8. day 47: invoice +¥420,000, bill −¥100,000; advance and line repaid
9. day 60: loan payment −¥45,000

Golden books (synthetic), mandate v1, request EX01; amounts in CNY. Data: work/fin/daily_cash.csv (independent recomputation, equal to the engine to the fen) · docs/techdoc-chat-fixes @ 571ea64f

Figure 2. The demo company's closing cash, days 0 to 62, against the ¥300,000 reserve. Today's books fall to −¥105,000 on days 30–31; FLOW's standing plan (¥3,113.93) touches the reserve on day 30 and never goes below it; the request accepted as asked falls ¥90,040 short on day 47; Option A as the demo runs it holds the reserve every day, including the new ¥200,000 payroll on day 42. Numbered markers date the events. Data: the financial audit's independent recomputation, equal to the engine to the fen (synthetic golden books, mandate v1, build 571ea64f).

What is new. Each building block exists somewhere: negotiation agents, cash-flow forecasts, loan marketplaces and covenant monitoring. What FLOW adds is the combination, on the supplier's side:

- **An agent the supplier owns, bounded by its own signed limits across both debt books:** what it may promise buyers, and what it may borrow to keep those promises.
- **A promise is treated as a liability before it costs anything.** A contingent concession counts at its maximum exposure and an unapproved loan counts as zero, on a dated daily cash forecast. That forecast is a hard boundary for every decision, together with a cap on total concessions and the bank's covenants.
- **Autonomy only with proof (ADR-0005).** FLOW may accept a buyer's offer on its own only when it can show it has accounted for every figure and request in the message. Otherwise the owner decides.
- **One deterministic pipeline.** Reading, forecasting, funding, covenants, the signed mandate, commitments and an injection-resistant typed interface form a single pipeline, not a set of independent tools.

Table 2. Products in the same space (vendor descriptions; "difference" is our reading of public material).

Product	What it does	How FLOW differs
Pactum	Buyer-side agents that negotiate payment days, discounts and rebates	FLOW sits on the other side of the table
MYbank 百灵 / AI 票据管家	Lender agents that tailor the bank's own credit and bill products	FLOW is supplier-owned and compares several sources, starting from the trade terms that cause the need
Xero JAX Cash Flow Actions	Ledger-side cash-gap detection and suggested plans	FLOW reads incoming offers and decides them inside a signed mandate and covenants
Cerebro Capital, Capitalise, Codat, Lendio	Lender marketplaces and debt-capacity tools for banks or mid-market firms	FLOW starts before the owner decides to borrow, at the request that creates the need

Innovation & Interaction: what the owner sees

FLOW is one web app with eight pages on its menu (Home, Deals, Attach deals, Cash & funding, Sandbox, Capex, Receivables, Activity), a chat on every page, and an account menu. Table 3 lists every screen. Appendix E follows one supplier through them in order.

Table 3. Every screen, what the owner does there and what FLOW does (the web app computes no figure; the server writes every figure and sentence).

Screen	The owner	FLOW
Set up your books (`/setup`, six steps)	Enters the company, cash, monthly sales and costs; credit lines and loans being repaid; customers with repeating contracts and unpaid invoices; bills coming up; the limits (minimum cash, the rate above which FLOW must ask before borrowing, concessions a year, the approval threshold, covenants, validity). Can fill a lender or customer step from an uploaded agreement. Re-types the owner token to sign	Checks each step, shows a 90-day "First look" at what Home will say, signs mandate version 1 and opens the books with one entry that starts a new evidence chain. Bills and limits are fixed after setup; changing them means a new setup and a new signature
Home (`/`)	Sees whether cash is safe and what waits	The cash outlook (lowest cash ahead, the forecast with its events, *What we recommend*: the plan, its cost and whether it needs approval); *Your worklist* (needs you, waiting, customers); cash available today with a funding ring; upcoming movements, including what customers owe late; what is owed, by customer
Attach deals (`/documents`)	Drops a contract or lender agreement, then picks who it is with	Reads every term beside its clause; checks that the chosen company is the

Screen	The owner	FLOW
	from the list of known companies, or adds a new customer from that list	contract's buyer, vendor or lender, as its kind needs; offers to refile a misfiled reading; after *Confirm*, says what was saved, under which customer, and that the forecast is unchanged. Compares a lender agreement with the facility in the books. From a confirmed customer contract, *Set up in my books* adds its repeating invoice (Tier 2, undoable; ADR-0014)
A customer (`/customers/{id}`)	Opens any customer by name	What the customer is worth, what is outstanding, the financing linked to it and its share of what the business is owed; the receivable-to-cash flow; its deals and record; how it has paid; concentration and exposure, with a link that redraws Cash with that customer 30 days late; an inputs sheet for facts the books do not hold
Deals (`/deals`)	Reads buyer messages, checks a request, sends or copies the reply, records the buyer's answer as the owner heard it, accepts as asked or declines	*Buyer messages*; *Your deals*, filed by who owes the next step (all, needs you, waiting, agreed); the verdict with Options A and B; *Cash impact* with business consequences and *Before they ask*; *Your agreements*, grouped by payment late, awaiting payment and closed, with a row for a contract on file with no deal yet and for a customer with invoices only; each deal's lifecycle strip and tracker
Cash & funding (`/cash`)	Runs or queues the plan	The plan, other plans considered, the 30/60/120-day forecast, the funding in use, the price of earlier cash, and the forecast with one customer paying late. On books with no committed source able to carry a permanent need, the plan and the menu still show, and the page says that no marginal source exists
Sandbox (`/whatif`)	Moves the terms, discount, rebate, price rise and early-settled amount of a real request	The verdict, lowest cash, concession cost and covenants. Nothing is written
Capex (`/capex`, with `/buy`, `/finance`, `/plans`)	Tests a machine, works through a vendor contract, commits a purchase	Health figures, the financing structures screened (a figure that does not apply shows a dash, with the reason), *Apply* (Tier 2), the borrower file, financial health, loan eligibility and long-term plans
Receivables (`/receivables`)	Records a payment; copies a chase message	What each invoice nets after financing; a payment's effect: the rest stays open, a financed invoice repays its lender first, and the reconciliation's reading
Activity (`/activity`)	Reads what happened	Every operation and security event, newest first, with filters that hide but never remove, the chain check, the evidence per entry, and a *Reconciliation* tab
Approvals (`/approvals`)	Approves or declines	One card per request, with its terms, the stored quote and today's price if it moved. No "approve all"
Ask FLOW (header, side panel, `/ask`)	Asks in English or Chinese, including small talk and "what will FLOW never do?"	Speaks first; answers from the books as cards with links to the page that shows the answer; proposes plans that run only on "go ahead"; the full page holds the conversation in one card

Screen	The owner	FLOW
Your limits (`/limits`); **Security and evidence** (`/trust`)	Reads the signed limits in plain words; downloads the record	What FLOW may do alone, what waits and what never happens; the evidence export, verifiable offline; the security events and the FastCapital scene
Demo (`/demo`, Demo mode)	Plays the six-scene story; moves the clock; loads other books	The story on the demo company, operator tools and the engine views (mandate, cash line, funding, verdict, ledger, alerts, reconciliation, security)

Every Business screen is in English and Chinese (the Demo's engine views are in English), and a tour (*Show me around*) explains twelve pages, opening by itself on a first visit.

What we claim, and what we do not. Claims:

- No model output alone can create a commitment, borrow or move money in FLOW.
- Every verdict carries its failing rule, the figures, the formula and the source words.
- On the 115 held-out buyer messages tested since ADR-0005, FLOW accepted 3 on its own and none of them was misread.

We do not claim that FLOW is a lender, broker or adviser, that it complies with any bank's covenants, that it has been deployed, or that it reads contracts or messages perfectly. It does not. Section 03 says by how much.

02 System Architecture

- Architecture diagram and component responsibilities

FLOW is a modular monolith: one FastAPI service (`services/api`), one Next.js web app (`apps/web`) and one database. Modules talk only through typed contracts in `app/domain/`, and import cycles are forbidden. Figure 3 shows the whole system: who calls it, the three places a model assists, the deterministic core that computes every figure, and the action path through which every operation that commits the business or moves money must pass.

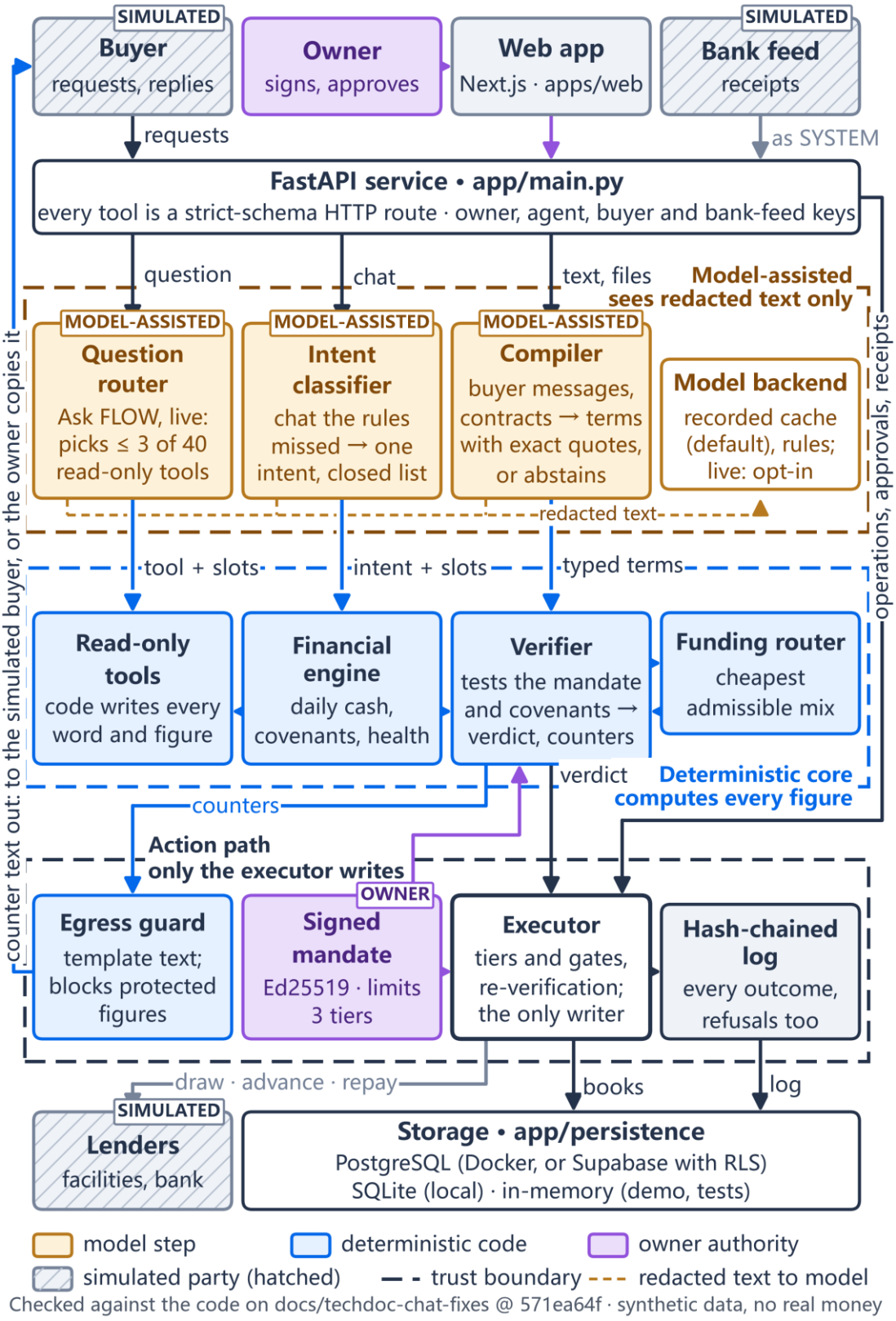


Figure 3. FLOW's architecture. A model assists in three places only (reading documents and buyer messages, classifying a chat request the rules miss, routing an owner's question to read-only tools); in live mode it gets text with identifying numbers redacted, and code validates its typed output. Deterministic code computes every figure; every typed operation passes the signed mandate and the executor, which records each outcome in a hash-chained log. Buyer, lenders and bank feed are simulated. Build 571ea64f.

Table 4. The roles in the pipeline.

Role	Code	May	May not
Compiler (the main model-assisted role, untrusted)	`compiler/`	Turn text into typed obligations, each tied to the exact source words. Flag authority claims, data requests and unknown lenders. Prove whether it accounted for everything	See the books, the mandate, the funding options or a buyer's limits. Emit an operation, a tier or a reply
Chat front (rules first; model-assisted in live mode only)	`nl/`, `nl/router/`	Read an owner's request with the deterministic parser; in live mode, label a request the parser misses from a closed list of intents, or route a question to read-only tools. Answer from the books; store a plan for "go ahead"	Execute anything a model chose; approve or reject through the classifier; read a buyer's message as a request
Verifier	`financial/`, `covenants/`, `verifier/`	Project the cash trajectory, test the mandate and covenants, return a verdict with formulas and priced counters	Read free text (enforced by a test on its imports)
Negotiator	`verifier/counters.py`, `counterparties/`, `egress/`	Price counters from the marginal cost of funds, run bounded rounds with the buyer, fill outbound templates	Reveal the reserve, caps, funding options or limits
Treasurer	`funding/`, `operations/`	Find the cheapest plan in its search space and execute typed operations through the permission gates	Rely on an uncommitted facility for a hard constraint; execute a Tier-3 action

One buyer request, end to end (Figure 4). The terms stay *proposed* until the executor has screened the buyer's acceptance; they become an *authorised* operation and a *recorded* commitment; the deal is *settled* only when the bank feed reports the cash and reconciliation marks the promise.

1. **Read.** The compiler proposes typed obligations, each with its source span, or abstains. A conflict between a message and its attachment, or a stated discount that does not equal rate × amount, gives NO_VERDICT. A coverage proof then checks that every figure and request in the text is accounted for.
2. **Screen.** Unknown senders, funding claims, unevidenced "we agreed last month" claims and data requests are logged as security events. None of them can book anything.
3. **Project.** The engine projects a conservative daily trajectory of cash, debt and future promises with the request's obligations.
4. **Fund.** The router prices any gap from committed facilities and returns the marginal cost of funds. Future concessions are valued at that rate.
5. **Decide.** The verifier tests every day and every month against the mandate and covenants, applies the break-even and autonomy rules, and returns a verdict. A rejection or counter comes with counters priced below the marginal cost.
6. **Negotiate.** The buyer answers within a bounded number of rounds. NO DEAL is a normal outcome.
7. **Execute.** Code, never a model, turns the verdict into typed operations. The executor runs Tier 1, queues Tier 2 for the owner, refuses Tier 3, and appends every outcome of an admitted operation to the hash-chained log. A request refused before it reaches the executor is recorded as a security event instead.

8. **Settle.** The bank feed (simulated) or the owner records each receipt; a receipt on a financed invoice repays the lender first; reconciliation reports each promised payment as awaited, received, lapsed or settled otherwise.

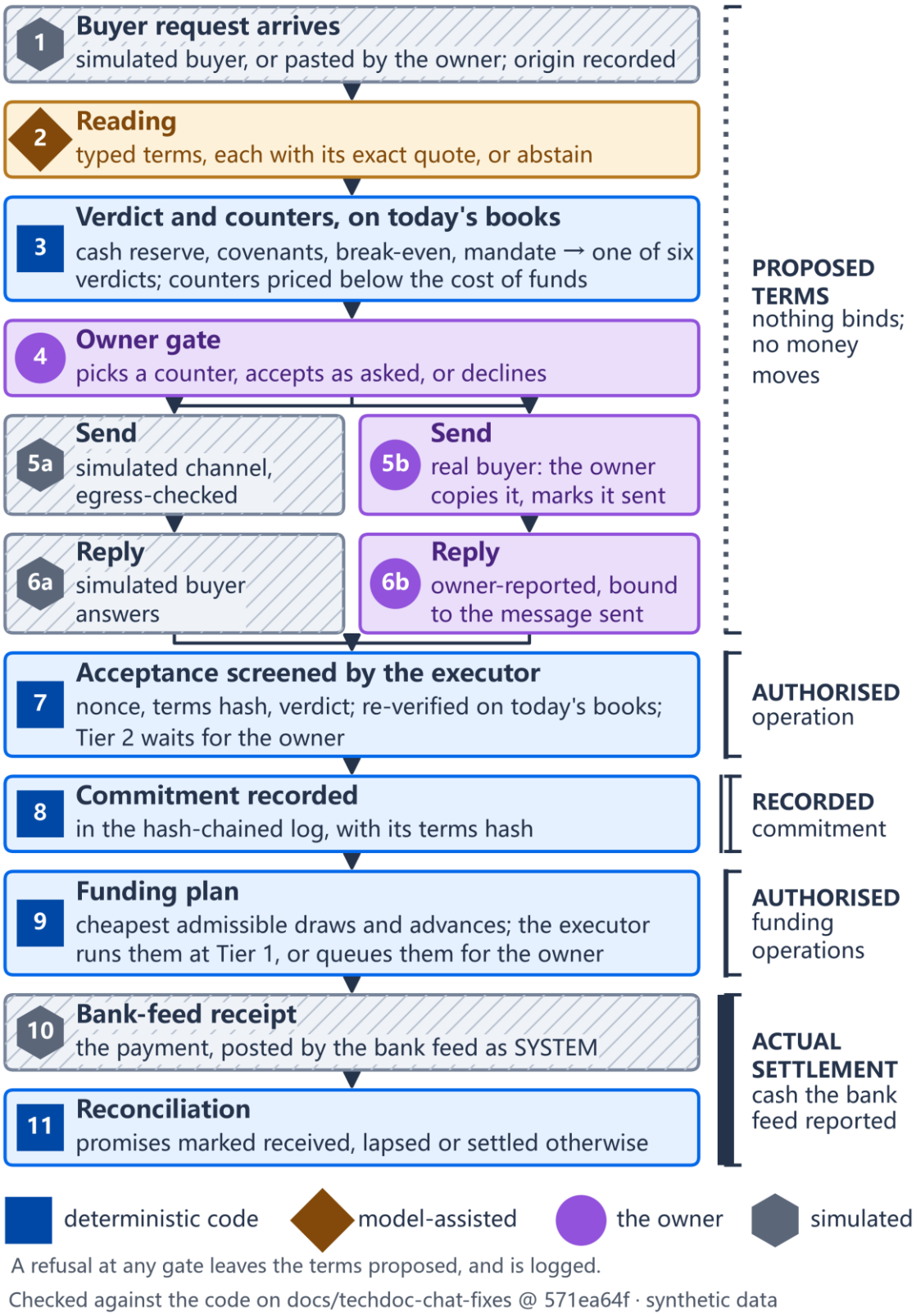


Figure 4. One buyer request from request to settlement. Steps 1 to 6 are proposed terms: nothing binds and no money moves. The executor's acceptance screen authorises the operation, the commitment is recorded in the hash-chained log, the funding plan runs as authorised operations, and the deal settles only when the simulated bank feed reports the cash and reconciliation marks the promise. Badge shapes show who acts: code, model, owner or a simulated party. Build 571ea64f.

How agreement happens, and what is simulated. A counter reaches the buyer in one of three ways. All three pass through the same gates afterwards: the single-use nonce, the terms hash, re-verification on that day's books, and the hash-chained log.

- **Through the simulated buyer (Demo mode).** The owner reviews the exact counter, then sends it with the verdict and books version it was built on. A changed counter is refused (409). The buyer in this build is a deterministic simulation with a hidden reservation price.
- **A registered buyer writing through its channel key.** FLOW answers at once within Tier 1, without an owner step: it counters, declines, or accepts a plain early-payment discount on a named invoice that passes every test and the coverage proof, inside the signed mandate. Anything else is queued for the owner (the authority matrix in section 04). A message without a channel key is a proposal only and executes nothing.
- **Outside FLOW.** The owner sends the counter themselves, for example by WeChat, and marks it as sent; the mark is bound to the exact message. FLOW transmits nothing itself. When the buyer answers, the owner records it: "accepted" and "declined" are bound to that message, and a pasted reply is read as a new request. FLOW does not authenticate the buyer's answer: an agreement recorded this way is **the owner's report**, checked against the terms and that day's books, not proof that the buyer agreed. After a counter is marked as sent outside, no other path can answer that request.

Who changes the books. Every typed operation that commits the business or moves money (accepting, countering or rejecting an offer, a commitment, a draw, invoice financing, a repayment, a receipt, an approval decision, a document decision, a capex step, a facility addition, a contract set-up) goes through one component, the executor, which checks it and records it in the tamper-evident log. Outside the executor, three owner or demo actions also change the books, each logged: moving the simulated clock (ADVANCE_CLOCK), opening books from setup (OPEN_BOOKS, demo mode) and adding a customer (ADD_CUSTOMER). A demo reset erases the books and the log (demo mode only). Stored offers, verdicts, contract readings, deal facts and chat sessions are records, not books.

Design decisions that matter.

- **Exact money.** Money is integer fen and rates are integer basis points, rounded half-up once per posting or valuation (ADR-0002).
- **Lead times are respected.** Funding is requested on the decision day and lands after its lead time, so a hard constraint never relies on money that has not arrived (ADR-0003).
- **Autonomy needs positive proof** (ADR-0005).
- **The browser computes no money and no dates.** Every figure and sentence is written by the server in English and Chinese (INVARIANT 13).
- **Errors say what they are.** An unexpected server error returns a JSON 500 with an error code and no exception text, with the CORS and security headers, so the web app reports a server error instead of "cannot reach the API".

The full component list is Appendix B.

- Models, tools, data sources and external services

Where a model is used: three model-assisted uses, each with a closed output.

1. **Reading documents and buyer messages (the compiler).** Buyer offers and messages (including a reply the owner pastes), term sheets, contracts, lender agreements, and setup's *Fill from an agreement*, become a strict JSON schema of typed terms. Setup is the one place a model-read number (a facility's limit, rate or fees) can reach the books, and only after the owner reviews the row and signs.
2. **Classifying an owner's chat request** that the deterministic parser cannot read, into one of 10 intents from a closed list that has no approve, reject or buyer-message intent. Its output never executes. In live mode with the question router on, a request it labels as a plain read (status, alerts, ratios, changes, comparing financing, a deal) is sent to the read-only answers and the router instead of a raw status view; action intents are never redirected.

3. **Routing an owner's question** that the deterministic answers miss to at most three tools from a closed menu of 40 read-only tools (ADR-0015, live mode only). Code runs the tools and writes every word and figure of the answer (section 03).

A model never decides, prices, negotiates, writes an answer or executes.

Table 5. Model backends.

Backend	Model	Used for
Cache (default)	Recorded readings keyed by a hash of the documents and the prompt version. The 19 shipped recordings were made by the rules grammar; no model output ships in the repository	Tests, the demo, the scenario runner and the offline evaluation. No network. A message not in the cache goes to the rules grammar
DeepSeek (live, opt-in)	`deepseek-flash` alias through the OpenAI-compatible API. The underlying model version is not recorded	A backend reachable from mainland China. Used for the live runs in section 03
Claude (live, opt-in)	`claude-sonnet-5-5`, with `claude-opus-5-5` for hard compilations	Alternative live backend
Rules grammar	Deterministic regular expressions and lexicon, Chinese and English	Always available. Every offline reading, and the fallback when a backend fails, times out or returns invalid JSON

What the model sees.

- **The document and the output schema, and nothing else.** The mandate, facility limits, buyers' limits and other buyers' terms are never attached to a model request, and a test on the compiler's imports keeps it that way. A person can still paste such figures into a message.
- **For the question router, only the redacted question and the tool menu.** The prompt is built without any access to the books; a test captures what the provider receives and checks that it holds no figure, name or limit, and that it is byte-identical whatever the books hold.
- **Identifying numbers are redacted first, in live mode, by every model call** (compiler, intent classifier and question router): bank and card numbers, phone numbers, email addresses, unified social credit codes, ID and passport numbers, and addresses after a label become placeholders. Redaction is on by default, and `pnpm demo --live-llm` forces it on. It is pattern-based: party names, amounts, clauses, chat ids, IBANs and unlabelled addresses still reach the provider (PRIV-4, PRIV-5). It has been tested with scripted models only, and live mode is outside every security certification.
- **Quotes are mapped back to the original** before grounding, so every term still points at the real words.
- **Logging.** Only a document hash and timings are logged per call, never the text.

Why a model at all. The rules grammar is precise but narrow. On 17 unseen Chinese contracts with a text layer, the rules grammar, which has no Chinese party pattern, found no party names. Recorded DeepSeek readings found both parties for 14 and swapped buyer and seller in 3. For example, the rules returned nothing for "甲方（承包人）：中山市华岳城建集团有限公司", while the model read both parties correctly. Both paths feed the same grounding and the same verifier: a term whose quote is not found word for word in the document is dropped, whichever path proposed it.

Three ways to run FLOW. They are never mixed in our results.

1. **Web on recorded mocks.** The web app alone, no API. Useful for the interface only (the screenshots in this document).
2. **Real engine, offline.** The full API with the rules grammar and its recorded readings. This is the demo, the tests and every evaluation figure unless stated otherwise.
3. **Real engine, live model.** The full API calling DeepSeek or Claude (`pnpm demo --live-llm`). Opt-in, needs a key, and outside every security certification.

The agent's tools. Every tool is an HTTP route with a strict schema that rejects unknown fields: 105 routes under `app/api` plus `/health` on `571ea64f` (`scripts/security_route_inventory.py`). They cover:

- setting up the books (demo mode only);

- the chat harness (`POST /nl`, and the opener in which the agent speaks first);
- offer intake, evaluation and negotiation, and the message to the buyer;
- the funding router, capex, financial health, loan eligibility and the borrower file;
- execution, receipts and approvals;
- the clock, alerts and reconciliation;
- contracts, customers and deals;
- the what-if sandbox and the strategy views;
- read views and the evidence export.

Appendix C lists them. Operations are typed:

- *offer:* accept, counter, reject, record a commitment;
- *funding:* draw, repay, finance an invoice, record a receipt;
- *owner:* apply for or add a facility, commit a purchase, confirm or reject a document;
- *Tier 3, always refused:* sign a personal guarantee, pledge collateral, issue equity, change the mandate.

No operation has a payee or account field, so FLOW cannot send money to a third party.

Data (all synthetic).

- **The demo company ("golden books"), day 0 = 1 October 2026.**
  - Cash ¥400,000; payroll ¥340,000 on day 12; a supplier payment of ¥120,000 on day 20; an operating bill of ¥100,000 on day 47.
  - An existing ¥1,500,000 loan at 0%, repaid ¥45,000 every 30 days; monthly EBITDA fixed at ¥90,000 (a fixture input).
  - Foshan's Receivable A of ¥420,000 due on day 32, and a ¥420,000 invoice issued on day 2 and every 30 days after, on 45-day terms.
  - An owner-signed mandate: a ¥300,000 cash reserve; a ¥5,000 cap on future concessions; DSCR at least 1.25× and leverage at most 2.5× (the synthetic credit line's covenants, repeated in the mandate); funding that costs more than 15% a year needs the owner's approval when FLOW asks for it; a commitment worth more than ¥100,000 in future concessions needs the owner.
- **Fixtures.**
  - 12 worked offers and three held-out sets of buyer messages.
  - Three demo contracts in Markdown, Word and PDF.
  - 70 synthetic Chinese contracts in four formats for the contract-reading evaluation, kept outside the repository.
  - Alternative books: busy, short of facilities, blank, and a set calibrated from a public filing.
- **The owner's own books.** On blank books, the setup wizard turns what the owner types (and the agreements it reads) into books of the same shape.
- **Test suites.** The 279-case attack catalogue, the 49 scripted agent tasks, the 503-turn owner-question bank and the 345 everyday owner wordings.

Table 6. The demo company's funding options (synthetic; only the owner can add to them).

Facility	Status	Price	Time to cash
Bank credit line, ¥150,000 limit, 30-day clean-down	Committed	6.4% simple, Actual/365	same day
Invoice financing, up to 80% of an invoice's open face, ¥350,000 limit	Committed	7.8% + 0.25% per whole 30-day period (10.84% all-in tariff equivalent)	3 days
Buyer early-payment offer	Committed	1.2% discount	2 days
Bank acceptance-bill discounting	Committed (no bill held at the start)	0.58% a year	1 day
Government-guaranteed working-capital loan	Not applied	5.0% all-in	21 days
Equipment loan, 36 months / equipment lease, 48 months	Not applied	5.6% / 7.2%	14 / 10 days

Facility	Status	Price	Time to cash
Equity	Reference only (Tier 3)	n/a	n/a

External services.

- **No real finance APIs.** No bank, lender, payment or blockchain API is called.
- **Model provider.** In live mode only, the configured provider (DeepSeek or Anthropic) receives the redacted inbound documents and the schema, the redacted owner requests the parser cannot read, and, with the router switched on, an owner's redacted question with the tool menu. With DeepSeek, text goes to a provider in mainland China.
- **Database.** PostgreSQL (Docker Compose, or Supabase in Singapore), with row-level security on every table and no access for Supabase's public roles. Locally, SQLite or memory.
- **Libraries.**
  - API: Python 3.12, FastAPI, Pydantic v2, SQLAlchemy 2 with Alembic (migrations 0001 to 0009) and PyNaCl (Ed25519).
  - Web: Next.js 16.3.8, React 19, Tailwind 4 and Recharts.
  - Tests: pytest, hypothesis and Playwright.

03 Agent Design

- Intent understanding, planning, tool use and state management

Understanding a request.

- **A deterministic parser (Chinese and English) maps each chat request to one of 23 intents** and fills typed slots. Examples: evaluate an offer, negotiate, speed up a receipt, fund a gap, show status, compare financing, explain, what-if, approve, reject, answer from the books (ASK_BOOKS), out of scope.
- **Who is asking comes from authentication, never from the text.** A buyer's message is never parsed for intents. It is compiled and verified as an inbound offer.
- **A question is answered, never executed.** A question gate runs before every action rule. "Can we pay off our loans?" is answered from the books; it never proposes a repayment, compiles an offer, queues anything or writes to the log. Answers come from a read-only module of about 40 figures computed by the engine's own functions, so every number is the one the screens show, and each answer leads with the yes, the no or the figure. (In live mode the intent classifier can still turn a question into a *proposed* plan; the live stress test below counts how often.)
- **A Tier-3 request put as a question is still a request.** "Sign a personal guarantee?", "should we pledge the equipment?" or 要不要签个人担保? goes to the executor like the plain command: it is refused, logged and raises a Tier-3 security event. Only a question that plainly asks for information and proposes nothing ("What is a personal guarantee?", "Is equity an option?") is answered, and only for the owner.
- **A question never cancels a waiting plan.** Asked about an action while a plan waits for "go ahead" ("should we draw ¥100,000 on the line?"), FLOW says that the earlier plan is still waiting, what it does and what it costs, and that "go ahead" runs that plan, not what was just asked about.
- **A terms question prices the terms asked for, with two-turn memory.** "From 45 to 60 days", "60 days instead of 45" or 账期从 45 天改成 60 天 is read for the terms asked for apart from the ones they replace (to, instead of, 改成, 延长到). Day counts the words do not tell apart are asked back, never guessed, and the days of an early-payment window ("2% off if they pay in 10 days") are not terms. Terms no longer than the buyer's current ones are never priced and never called acceptable. When FLOW has to ask which customer, it keeps the terms already read, and the owner's next short reply

naming one customer finishes the question. The answer, the router's tool and the what-if share one writer.

- **"Can I pay everyone?"** "Can I pay everyone?" or "Can I pay all my bills this month?" adds every outflow in the window (this month, or the next 30 days when none is named): payroll, suppliers, loan payments and the rest. It checks them against the reserve and against zero on the conservative forecast Home draws, and says yes or no, the first day below the reserve, the day below zero and the lowest point. When cash falls short, the answer offers FLOW's plan with its cost and saves it, so the owner's "go ahead" runs it, or queues it for approval, through the executor and the mandate checks. The answer itself runs nothing, and it never replaces a different kind of plan that waits.
- **Customers, borrowing and the record.** "If my biggest customer doesn't pay, how long can we last?" and "what happens if Dongguan stops ordering?" are answered on a model copy of the books without that customer's money (its open invoices and recurring invoicing, or only the invoicing still to come), against today's forecast; a customer with nothing open is said so plainly. "Can we borrow against the Foshan invoice?" gives what invoice financing would advance on it, the cost and the days to cash; nothing is submitted or drawn. Days sales outstanding is answered from the receivables, and "what did FLOW do?" names each operation in the audit log. Everyday ways of saying "show me my cash" open the cash answer.
- **Small talk and limits.** Greetings, thanks and "who are you?" get a short reply in the message's language, and "what will FLOW never do?" or "can FLOW borrow by itself?" is answered from the tier table: Tier 3 never, Tier 2 only after the owner. Recognition is whole-message only, so "hi, fund the gap" or a greeting followed by an instruction goes through the rules as before.
- **Claims are named for what they are.** A buyer who writes "as agreed with your team, we will now pay on 60-day terms" is told that no terms agreement is on record, in the chat reply and in the message to the buyer. Nothing is booked from a claim, and the claim is logged as a security event.
- **Everyday wording.** After the literal patterns, a scored matcher reads casual, misspelt or worried wording in both languages ("can my company survive this month?", 我们撑得过这个季度吗) and answers only when one question clearly wins. A horizon longer than the 120-day forecast is answered on the forecast and says so.
- **The intent classifier (live mode only)** is consulted only when the parser finds nothing, and may choose only from its closed list; approve, reject and buyer messages are not in it, and its choice never executes. With the question router on, a request it labels as a plain read goes to the answers and the router, not to a raw status view.
- **The question router (ADR-0015, live mode only).** When the deterministic answers and the topic reads both miss, a model may choose up to three of 40 read-only tools and fill their typed slots; code answers. It sees only the redacted question, fenced as data, and the tool menu, never the books. Its output is validated strictly: a canary check, exact JSON with no extra or duplicate keys, known tools, every slot checked against its schema twice. One bad call rejects the whole response, and a rejection, timeout, provider error or cache miss falls back to the honest "I cannot answer that yet" with the nearest read. For a terms question, code reads the day count from the owner's own words, whatever number the model copied into the slot. It runs for the owner only, behind `FEATURE_ASK_ROUTER`; no routes are recorded, so offline it changes nothing. Logs keep a hash of the question, never its text. The ADR is *proposed*; the Security Lead reviewed the router on `6d2b6941` and its four findings were fixed in `70f23ac5`. Live mode, where the router acts, is outside every security certification.
- **Every id is checked against the registry.**

Innovation & Interaction: dialogue efficiency, clarification, correction and fallback

- **Dialogue efficiency.** The 49 scripted tasks take 88 turns, 1.8 turns per task: most requests are answered or planned in one turn, and "go ahead" is the second. FLOW speaks first after time moves or money lands, so the owner does not have to ask what changed.
- **Clarification.** "Fund it" with two open gaps asks which one. A terms question with an ambiguous day count asks back. A question that needs a customer asks which, and finishes on the next turn.

- **Correction.** "Make it 0.8%" amends the plan. "1%" is refused, because it is above the 0.88% break-even.
- **Fallback.** An unmatched request gets the nearest thing FLOW can do, not a flat refusal; a question the books cannot answer gets "I cannot answer that yet" with the nearest read; a model that fails, times out or returns invalid output falls back to the rules grammar or the deterministic answers, never to a guess.

Consent: instructions that move money execute only when they are unambiguous.

- A financial instruction runs only when the whole message is one closed, affirmative command with exactly one RMB amount.
- These execute nothing, in English and Chinese: a negation, a question, a condition, a future time, a foreign currency, an unreadable amount, an extra request, or quoted or pasted text.
- An approval runs only on an exact decision sentence naming its id.

Propose, then confirm.

- A plan is stored with the exact typed operations shown, the quoted cost and the books it was built on.
- "Go ahead" runs exactly those operations. If the books have moved to a different or dearer plan, FLOW shows the new proposal instead.
- A new day or a changed mandate cancels the plan.

Planning examples.

- **A goal.** "Get paid early on the Foshan invoice without giving anything away next quarter" becomes an early-payment counter at 0.85% with no future concession, with invoice financing as the fallback if the buyer refuses.
- **Several steps.** Draw the line, finance an invoice, repay on receipt.

Acting first. After time moves or money lands, FLOW names what needs the owner and proposes a cure found on the current books, priced as the executor will charge it. It then waits; the executor decides the permission tier. FLOW proposes no cure when the mandate forbids new borrowing, and no repayment while a reserve breach is open. Day 34 of the journey in section 01 is an example.

Ask FLOW, as the owner uses it.

- **Where.** A field in the page header, a side panel on every page, and a full page (`/ask`) for the same conversation. The full page holds the conversation in one card: the thread scrolls inside it and the composer is pinned at its foot. Each page suggests questions it can answer. *New conversation* clears it here and on the server, so a later "go ahead" runs nothing.
- **FLOW speaks first.** When the panel or page opens on an empty conversation, FLOW names what needs the owner and its priced cure, in the owner's words and with no internal ids.
- **Answer cards.** An answer from the books leads with its sentence, shows up to three key figures, the rest of the reply, how FLOW worked it out, and up to three links to the page that shows it. Links only open pages; a card never approves, sends or runs anything. Every word and link is written on the server, and a browser test clicks each one.
- **Language.** The reply follows the question: a Chinese question is answered in Chinese, an English one in English, whatever the page's language.
- **Doing, not only answering.** A plan shows its exact operations and cost with *Yes, run it* and *Cancel*. "Approve APR-000002" approves that request; a bare "approve it" binds only to the request the conversation just showed. Chat never records a fact ("add a ¥80,000 bill" is refused).

Tool use. Handlers call module functions (compile, evaluate, plan, negotiate) and send typed operations to the executor. Each operation carries an idempotency key built from the session, turn and step. No handler can skip the verifier or build an operation from model output.

State.

- **Sessions.** A chat session holds only typed references: the last offer and verdict, a pending plan, a pending clarification, and a pending question with the slots already read (`Session.pending_ask`). Since SEC-21, it continues only for the caller that opened it. A what-if clarification likewise resumes the words that raised it.

- **Books.** The store holds today's position. Commitments hold agreed changes not yet realised, and every projection runs on the two combined (ADR-0006).
- **Time.** Time is a simulated day that moves only through the clock. Each move posts scheduled flows, issues recurring invoices and expires lapsed commitments.
- **Settlement.** Partial payments leave the residual open. A receipt on a financed invoice repays the lender first, from that receipt only. Reconciliation reports each promised early payment as awaited, received, lapsed or settled otherwise.
- **Commitments are re-checked.** A verdict is not standing authority. At acceptance and at approval, the executor checks again on the books of that moment and refuses a commitment that no longer holds (STALE_VERDICT).
- **The decision record** derives each deal's state from stored facts (ADR-0011).
- **Contract records** hold a document's reading with each term's quoted clause and the owner's hash-bound decision (ADR-0012). From a confirmed customer contract, the owner can set up that customer's repeating invoice in the books; the conservative forecast counts it from the first invoice the clock issues (ADR-0014).

From setup to settlement: what FLOW keeps track of.

- **Opening the books.** The setup wizard's six steps (Table 3) are checked by the server and previewed as a 90-day forecast before anything is written. *Sign and open my books* signs mandate version 1 and writes one opening entry that heads a fresh evidence chain; it is refused once the books hold any activity.
- **Documents.** The file comes first; the owner then picks the company from the books' list or adds a new customer from it (Tier 2). The party check looks for the chosen company in the role the document's kind needs: the buyer of a customer contract, the vendor of a purchase contract, the lender of a lender agreement. It matches by company (case, punctuation and the legal-form suffix ignored), never by a first word or part of a name. It blocks *Confirm* when that party is another company or was not found in that role, and shows the companies the document does name. *Refile* moves the reading to the right customer without a new model call. A lender agreement is compared with the facility already in the books and can be linked to it, which changes nothing in the facility.
- **Customers.** Each customer's overview is computed from the books: gross contribution, outstanding, the financing linked to its invoices, its share of what the business is owed, its payment history, and its exposure. A new customer is refused when its name looks like a company already on the registry, reads as an id, is the business's own name, or takes a short name another customer already answers to.
- **Deals.** One queue files every request by who owes the next step. Once the owner has a reply, FLOW drafts it exactly; the owner sends it through the simulated buyer (Demo mode) or by their own channel, then records the buyer's yes, no or reply as the owner heard it. When FLOW has no counter, *accept as asked* or *decline* is itself the owner's decision. Each deal shows a lifecycle strip (received, analysed, reply ready, sent, agreed) and, once agreed, a tracker of promised against actual (terms negotiated, early payment in, collecting, fulfilled).
- **Money over time.** The simulated clock posts scheduled flows, lands funding, issues recurring invoices and expires lapsed commitments; it never records a receipt. The owner records a payment on Receivables as a Tier-1 receipt, and FLOW says what reached cash, what repaid a lender first and what is still open. Alerts are recomputed on each day's books: an overdue invoice (critical when it is financed), a reserve breach ahead with its funding cure, repaying a drawn credit line once cash allows, an agreement expiring within 7 days, and the signed limits expiring within 14 days.

- Core algorithms and evaluation approach

1. Daily cash trajectory. For each day of the horizon:

```
closing(t) = opening(t) + inflows(t) − scheduled outflows(t) − interest, fees and repayments(t)
```

- **Order within a day.** Inflows come first, then outflows, then financing costs. Closing cash is tested against the reserve. This is a closing-cash test; it does not model liquidity within a day.

- **What "conservative" means.** Unconfirmed inflows and overdue receivables are ignored; only committed facilities can be drawn, others count as zero; a contingent concession counts at its maximum; a repeating invoice set up from a contract counts only once the clock has issued its first invoice (ADR-0014).
- **What it does not cover.** Recurring invoices are assumed to be paid on their due day, so the forecast is not conservative about collections. The stress tests (Table 11) cover that.
- **Charges.** Credit-line interest is Actual/365 simple, posted at repayment. Invoice financing bills interest and its fee in whole 30-day periods, at least one, so an advance held for less than a period costs more than its 10.84% tariff.

Figure 2 (section 01) draws the trajectory of the demo books under four scenarios.

2. Funding router. It searches for the cheapest plan that keeps closing cash at or above the reserve on every day, breaks no covenant and is allowed by the mandate:

- **Search space.** A discrete search: up to three actions, amounts on a ¥10,000 grid, no action below ¥1,000, every source requested on the decision day and landing after its lead time. It searches amounts, not dates.
- **Ranking.** A plan FLOW may run alone ranks before a cheaper plan with a leg that needs the owner (a leg above the 15% approval threshold); within each class, the cheapest wins.
- **Plans that cannot run.** A plan that relies on an action no operation can perform yet (a buyer's early payment, a bill FLOW does not hold, an invoice not yet issued) is labelled "cannot run today". When no plan in the search space is admissible, the router says so.
- **On the demo company**, the ¥405,000 gap before day 32 is covered by the credit line (¥150,000, interest ¥841.64) plus invoice financing (¥255,000, ¥2,272.29 for one 30-day period): **¥3,113.93**. Taking the buyer's 1.2% discount instead would cost ¥5,040.00.
- **How close to optimal.** Within ¥1 of a bounded brute-force search on all 26 evaluation scenarios (pairs on a ¥5,000 grid, triples on a ¥10,000 grid; the time budget was reached in 2 priced cases, judged against the best plan the brute force found). The brute force is independent search code but uses the engine's own projection. This is optimality within the search space, not over every possible amount or date.

3. Marginal cost and break-even.

- **Marginal cost of funds.** The rate at which FLOW prices a concession: invoice financing's 10.84% all-in, the cheapest committed source that the credit line's clean-down rule allows to carry a permanent need. It is a pricing rate, not an executable quote: the platform advances at most 80% of an invoice and bills whole periods.
- **Break-even.** An early-payment discount d is cheaper than borrowing only if $d < c/(1+c)$, where c is that source's cost for the days paid early. For 30 days $c = 7.8\% \times 30/365 + 0.25\% = 0.8911\%$, so the break-even is **0.8832%**.
- **The early-payment rule (ADR-0007).** An early payment is accepted only if it passes three tests: it is below break-even for its actual days early; the cash is needed; and it is cheaper than the router's plan without it. So 0.75% on the whole ¥420,000 invoice costs ¥3,150.00, more than the ¥3,113.93 plan, and is countered; 0.74% costs ¥3,108.00 and is accepted.

4. Covenants. Each projected 30-day month is tested against the synthetic credit line's definitions:

- **DSCR** = EBITDA ÷ debt service, with EBITDA fixed at ¥90,000 a month and a bullet loan serviced on a level basis (ADR-0008).
- **Leverage** = month-end drawn debt ÷ (12 × monthly EBITDA).
- **Clean-down** = the longest run of zero-balance days on a credit line.

DSCR here is a **forward-looking monthly screening proxy** for a synthetic covenant, not the trailing-twelve-month test on reported accounts that a bank would normally apply. For example, a 12-month bullet ¥500,000 government-guaranteed loan, levelised, would bring DSCR to 1.01×, below the 1.25× covenant, so FLOW refuses it.

5. Verdict. The verifier checks, in this order: whether the offer was read completely; the security screen; mandate validity; the projection; every rule (daily reserve, the total and per-buyer concession caps, the discount

cap, the implied rate of an early-payment discount against the 15% threshold, the covenants and the Tier-3 clauses); the three early-payment tests; and the autonomy rule. Every failed rule carries its code, the day or month, the observed value, the limit, a formula and its inputs. The autonomy rule (ADR-0005) keeps an ACCEPT at Tier 1 only for a plain early-payment discount on a named whole invoice that passes all three tests **and** whose message passed the coverage proof. Anything else that would be accepted becomes "needs the owner".

The worked example, reconciled. Table 7 traces the demo's central request (EX01) through every figure the document and the screens use, on the books of day 0. It answers a common question: why does the forecast say ¥90,040 while the deal page says "breached by ¥135k for 15 days"? Both are right: ¥90,040 is the shortfall on the **first** day below the reserve (day 47), ¥135,040 the **worst** (day 60), and the breach lasts 15 days (47 to 61).

Table 7. The EX01 request, every figure in one place (golden books, day 0, books version 1, reserve ¥300,000; CNY).

Scenario	Funding	Lowest cash	Breach	Discount	Funding cost	Future concessions	Can run today?	Who decides
Today's books, no request	none	−¥105,000 (days 30–31)	days 12–31 (20 days), at worst ¥405,000 short	—	—	¥0	—	—
Today's books + FLOW's standing plan	line ¥150,000 + invoice financing ¥255,000	¥300,000 (day 30)	none	—	**¥3,113.93**	¥0	yes	Tier 1
EX01 as asked (1.2% early pay, 60-day terms, rebate), no new funding	none	¥164,960 (day 60)	first day 47, ¥90,040 short; worst day 60, **¥135,040** short; 15 days	¥5,040.00	—	**¥28,326.92** (terms ¥24,326.92 over 13 invoices + rebate ¥4,000), against a ¥5,000 cap	—	**Rejected**: concession cap, reserve, above break-even, dearer than the plan
EX01 + its cheapest cure	invoice financing ¥135,040 on an invoice issued on day 32	¥300,000	none	¥5,040.00	¥2,406.67	¥28,326.92	**no**: the invoice does not exist yet	—
EX01 + the plan that can run	credit line ¥135,040, drawn today, repaid day 62	¥300,000	none	¥5,040.00	¥1,468.05	¥28,326.92	yes	—
Early-payment test inside the verdict	with the early payment: ¥6,508.05; without it (same terms): ¥3,873.58	—	—	—	—	—	—	the early payment is dearer, so countered
Option A (FLOW's counter)	credit line ¥147,210	¥300,000 (day 30)	none	¥2,210.00 on ¥260,000 at 0.85%	¥825.99; total **¥3,035.99**	¥0	yes	**Accept, Tier 1**

Scenario	Funding	Lowest cash	Breach	Discount	Funding cost	Future concessions	Can run today?	Who decides
Option B (FLOW's counter)	line ¥90,000 + invoice financing ¥315,000	¥300,000 (day 30)	none	—	**¥3,706.46** (¥592.53 more than the standing plan)	55 days + 0.30% price rise: a net forward gain of ¥162.05 over 13 invoices	the router's plan, yes	needs the owner (terms lengthen)

Funding cost and future concessions overlap: the EX01 cure pays for the cash effect of the first invoice's 15 extra days, which ¥24,326.92 already prices. Do not add them. On FLOW's pricing, accepting as asked gives away ¥5,040 now and ¥28,326.92 of future concessions, CNY 33,366.92 in all, and still needs funding for days 47 to 61.

6. Counters.

- **Option A, early payment.**
  - **Rate:** the largest whole-5-basis-point rate below break-even, here 0.85%.
  - **Amount:** the cash needed after the credit line, grossed up and rounded **up** to a whole ¥10,000: (405,000 − 150,000) ÷ (1 − 0.85%) = 257,186.08, so ¥260,000. Rounding stops a buyer reading FLOW's exact gap from the counter (R-10).
  - **Cost:** ¥3,035.99, ¥77.94 below the standing plan. It passes its own re-evaluation, stays within every mandate limit and binds to a commitment with the same terms hash. Its real value is that the supplier gets the cash it needs without the ¥28,326.92 of future promises the buyer asked for.
- **Option B, terms.** Longer terms with the smallest price rise that covers the funding cost of the extra days (0.30% of ¥420,000 = ¥1,260 against ¥1,247.53 per invoice). Every counter is re-evaluated as an offer on the same books, so FLOW offers 55 days, not 60: at 60 days a later invoice would land after a loan payment with no committed cure. Its books still need the ¥3,706.46 plan in Table 7, so FLOW recommends Option A.
- Outbound text is filled from an approved template, and the outbound guard checks it.

7. Simulated buyer. The buyer kernel works out its own surplus from a package: the discount, rebate and extra days, less its cost of paying early and any price rise. It accepts when the surplus reaches its hidden reservation, otherwise counters one step toward it, and refuses in its last round. In the one hard-line scenario tested, the demo ends in NO DEAL within three rounds, and the router still covers the gap for ¥3,113.93.

8. Capex screening. For an owner's planned machine purchase, FLOW screens each financing structure for daily liquidity and monthly covenants: cash with the line; an 18-month loan; a 36-month loan; a 48-month lease (modelled as a 7.2% amortising loan with no residual). It ranks the feasible structures by total financing charges, undiscounted.

On the synthetic ¥600,000 machine (+¥22,000 a month from month 4 to month 60; no residual value, tax or maintenance; NPV ¥380,885.77 at a 10% hurdle; simple payback in month 31, discounted payback in month 35), run on today's unfunded books, FLOW selects the lease (¥92,327.32 of charges). The 36-month loan is cheaper (¥53,206.14) but leaves cash ¥3,144.62 below the reserve for three days. Once FLOW's ¥3,113.93 plan has been paid, every structure needs a few days' bridge on the line (the lease ¥3.11, the 36-month loan ¥3.29).

The search tests **one structure at a time**. A 36-month loan plus a three-day bridge on the credit line (interest ¥1.65) would have no breach and about ¥39,000 less interest than the lease, undiscounted across a 36- and a 48-month tenor; in present value at the 10% hurdle the gap is **CNY 7,493.45**. FLOW does not try that combination today, so the selection is the best *standalone* structure. Applying for financing is a separate owner step that queues one Tier-2 application; the owner's approval records a simulated pending facility, which counts as zero until a lender commits. A figure that does not apply, such as the payment of a structure the funding menu rules out, shows a dash, and the result says why.

Around the screening, the Capex hub holds the rest of the buy side:

- **Purchase contracts.** A vendor contract is read like any document. FLOW lays out its payment schedule against the owner's timeline and prices the vendor's early-payment discount. *Commit* is Tier 2 and books the payments only on approval; a committed purchase has no cancel path yet (CAPEX-NC in the Security Self-Assessment).
- **Financial health.** Cash coverage, the current and quick ratios (from the owner's estimates), covenant room and the capacity left on each facility.
- **Loan eligibility.** Four illustrative catalogue loans read against the books. *Add to my funding menu* queues a Tier-2 facility addition that counts as zero until a lender commits.
- **Long-term plans.** Projects × financing structures × start months over 60 months, the top five by net present value.
- **The borrower file.** A lender-style file built from the verified books, as HTML or Word. It is prepared, never sent.

9. Strategy views. Two read-only views answer before a buyer asks:

- **The price of earlier cash**, on Cash & funding: what ¥10,000 arriving 30 days earlier is worth, by arrival day.
- **Before they ask** (the safe deal envelope), on a deal's *Cash impact*: how far each lever (terms, price, early-payment rate, rebate) can go on its own on today's books and what stops it, packages that pass every check, and the lowest price that works at each length of terms. Each package is re-checked before anything is sent.

Both are on in `pnpm demo`. The envelope repeats the funding search on its first read (about 17 s on the development machine, a single observation), so the demo computes it once in the background after each reset or setup, keyed by the books, mandate, day and commitments. Two further views are built behind flags that the demo leaves off: customer economics and a pilot journal.

Evaluation approach: how to read our numbers

We evaluate on three levels: the engine against an independent oracle and a brute force; the readers (buyer messages, contracts, owner questions) on items their authors had not seen; and the whole agent through scripted tasks and attacks. One offline command regenerates the engine and agent figures (`uv run --project services/api python scripts/evaluate.py`, 12 minutes on 18 Oct); Table 14 in section 05 gives every headline figure's build, date and command.

Every result carries its **evidence class**: *unseen held-out* (labels written before the code saw the items, scored once, and that first score is the one quoted); *tuned* (re-scored after fixes chosen by studying its failures, or a set that was the development target); *recorded model replay* (a model's past reading replayed offline); *live* (a provider called that day, one sample of a non-deterministic system); *rules* (no model); *scripted* (a fake model we wrote); and *tests*. **No result comes from a deployed system.** A test count measures the size of a suite, not correctness. Labels for buyer messages were written by AI agents in separate sessions, not by people. Figure 5 groups the accuracy results by class.

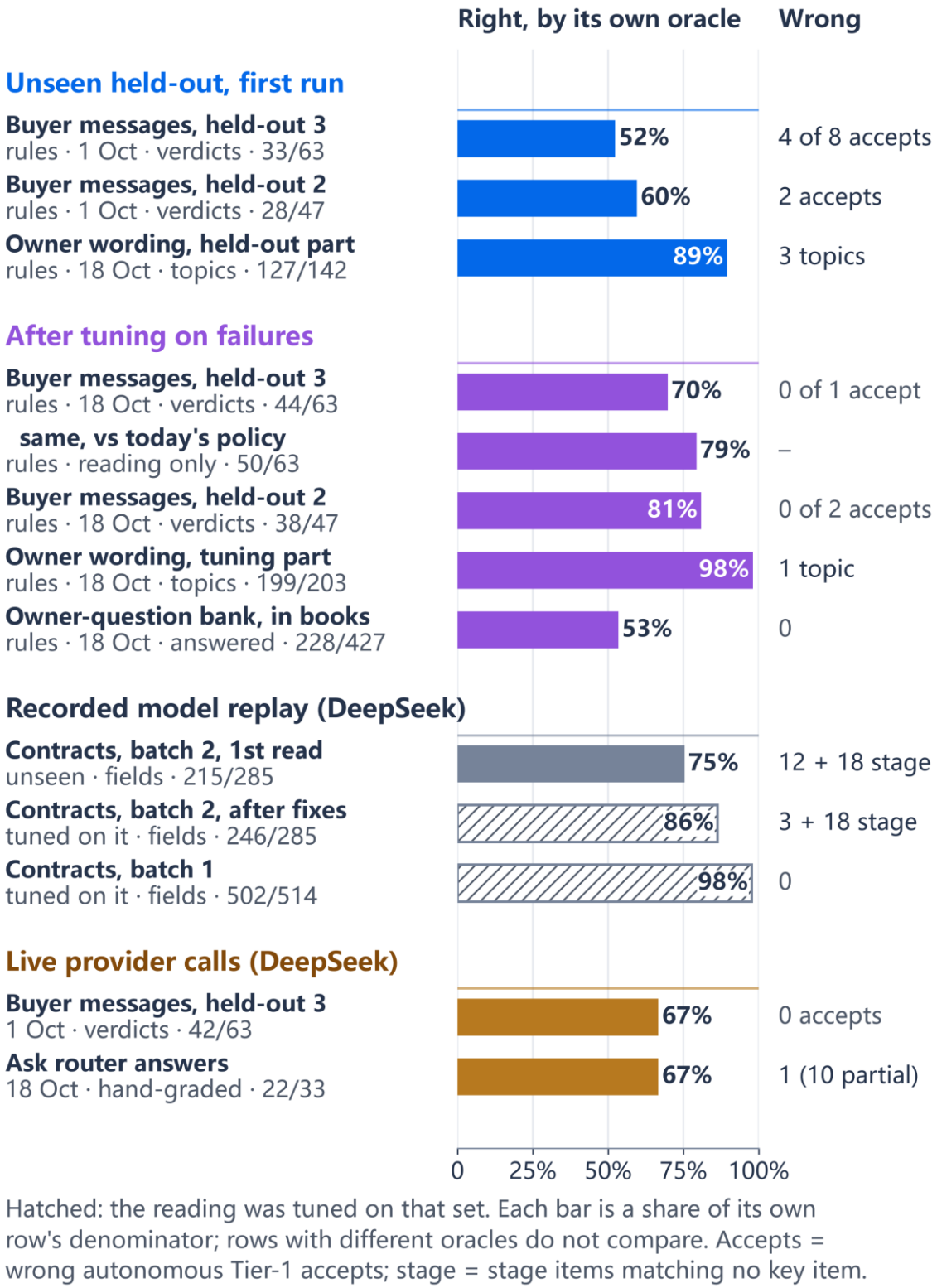


Figure 5. FLOW's accuracy results grouped by evidence class: unseen held-out first runs, the same sets after tuning on their failures, recorded DeepSeek readings and live DeepSeek calls. Each bar is a share of its own row's denominator (shown beside it), and the right-hand column shows what that row's own oracle scores wrong. Rows with different oracles do not compare. Offline re-runs on 571ea64f, 18 Oct 2026; live rows on the dates shown.

Task Completion: scripted tasks in a simulated environment

- **49 of 49 scripted conversations pass their own checks** (88 turns, 18 Oct, `571ea64f`), each with a verifiable evidence chain; a tampered copy of the chain is rejected. The tasks and their pass conditions were written by the team that built the handlers, so they show that the paths written work, not how real owners would talk.
- **The demo walk** (17 steps, the journey in section 01) exits cleanly with 14 hash-chained operations that verify.
- **The engine** matches an independently written oracle on 67 of 67 golden financial values to the fen, and on 27 of 27 covenant and capex values; mandate and covenant limits hold at the threshold and break one unit past it (20 of 20). The oracle shares the team and the specification, so a shared misreading of a rule would pass.

Reading buyer messages: safety beside usefulness

Two held-out sets of WeChat- and email-style buyer messages (66 and 49, Chinese, English and mixed) were labelled by separate AI-agent sessions before the reader saw them. **Their first runs are our only unseen figures:** verdicts matched the label on 33 of 63 and 28 of 47, and FLOW accepted **6 misread messages on its own** (4 of its 8 accepts on the first set, 2 on the second). That result led to the coverage proof (ADR-0005): FLOW may now accept alone only when it can account for every figure and request in the message. We then fixed the failure classes, so today's figures are tuned.

Table 8. Autonomy on the two held-out sets of buyer messages today (115 messages, rules path, 18 Oct, `571ea64f`; both sets have guided later fixes).

Step	Held-out 3	Held-out 2	Both
Buyer messages	66	49	115
Genuinely acceptable as asked today (plain early payment, cheaper than the plan)	10	4	**14**
… accepted by FLOW alone (autonomous acceptance coverage)	1	2	**3 (21%)**
… sent to the owner unnecessarily (unnecessary escalation)	9	2	**11 (79%)**
Not acceptable, and FLOW answered alone (counter or reject at Tier 1)	29	25	54
Not acceptable, and FLOW asked the owner (correctly)	27	20	47
Refusals to read (NO_VERDICT)	16	14	30 (26%)
Owner reviews needed	36	22	58 (50%)
Wrong autonomous accepts	**0 of 1**	**0 of 2**	**0 of 3**
First run, 1 Oct, before ADR-0005	*4 of 8 wrong*	*2 wrong*	*6 wrong*

What Table 8 shows.

- **Safety comes from a rule, not from a large sample.** With 3 autonomous accepts, "no wrong accept" is weak evidence by itself; the evidence is that FLOW refuses to accept alone without proof, which the first runs showed is necessary.
- **Most messages need no owner.** FLOW answers 57 of 115 on its own, mostly by countering or declining within the mandate.
- **That caution has a cost: 11 of the 14 good offers wait for the owner.** Ten of the 11 have one cause: the buyer named a settlement date ("tmrw", "国庆后", "next Mon") that FLOW does not yet read into the terms, so the coverage proof cannot account for it. Reading settlement dates is the next improvement. Until then, each such offer costs the owner one review, with the verdict and the source words shown.

Table 9. Reading buyer messages on the held-out sets.

Set and run	Class	Path	Verdict agreement	Material errors	Silent material errors	Wrong autonomous accepts
Held-out 3, first run (1 Oct, before ADR-0005)	**unseen**	rules	33/63 (52%)	4/51	7	4 of 8 accepts
Held-out 2, first run (1 Oct, before ADR-0005)	**unseen**	rules	28/47 (60%)	3/37	5	2
Held-out 3, today (18 Oct)	tuned	rules	44/63 (70%); 50/63 (79%) against today's policy	3/51 (5.9%)	4	0 of 1
Held-out 2, today (18 Oct)	tuned	rules	38/47 (81%); 44/47 (94%) against today's policy	0/37	0	0 of 2
Held-out 3, one live run (1 Oct, build `389cfd9`)	live; shared gates tuned, prompt not	DeepSeek	42/63 (67%)	3/51	5	0
Form baseline (labels typed into today's verifier)	tests	no reader	56/63 (89%)	—	—	—

Reading Table 9.

- **Two agreement figures for today.** The 1 Oct labels predate the early-payment rule (ADR-0007), so 7 labels in each set disagree with today's policy applied to the true terms. "Against today's policy" compares the reader's verdict with the policy on the true terms, separating "the reader is wrong" from "the policy changed". The form baseline shows the same drift from the policy side.
- **Targets not met.** The material-error target (≤ 5%) and the zero-silent-error target are missed on held-out 3. No silent error caused an autonomous accept: each ended with the owner or in a rejection.
- **The live run is one sample** on an older build, with the provider's model version unrecorded; it was not repeated, so run-to-run variation is unmeasured.

Appendix A gives the exact definitions of each metric.

Reading Chinese contracts

We generated 70 synthetic Chinese contracts with their answer keys (government procurement, goods, services, construction subcontracts, equipment installation, processing, leases, logistics and supplementary agreements; digital PDF, Word, scanned PDF and phone photo) and built the reader on the first 40.

- **Unseen: 75% of key fields on 17 contracts with a text layer.** Of 30 new contracts (six new contract types), 13 are scans or phone photos and are refused before any reading, because FLOW has no OCR. On the 17 with a text layer, recorded DeepSeek readings got **215 of 285** key fields right (**75%**; **45%**, 215 of 474, over all 30).
- **The fields that decide money.** Of the 234 fields that move money or gate a decision (total amount, stage percentages, days, day units and triggers, late interest, retention, end date, buyer and seller), **178 were right (76%)**, 11 were stated wrongly (including buyer and seller swapped in 3 contracts), 45 were missed, and 18 stage items were stated that match nothing in the contract. Payment triggers were the weakest field (17 of 33). The record-only fields (contract number, signing and start dates) were right on 37 of 51.
- **Tuned figures.** After five fixes chosen by studying these failures (slash and dot dates, a code check of who pays whom, repeated terms, the payer's late interest, end dates), the same set scores 86%, no longer held out; on the 40 contracts the reader was built on, 98%.
- **What limits the damage.** Every term must quote its clause word for word; code checks that stage percentages sum to 100 and stage amounts match the total; a reading changes nothing until the owner confirms it, and only a separate Tier-2 *Set up in my books* turns a contract into forecast invoices. Nothing here measures whether an owner would catch a plausible wrong stage or trigger. The contracts and readings are outside the repository, so these figures cannot be reproduced from it.

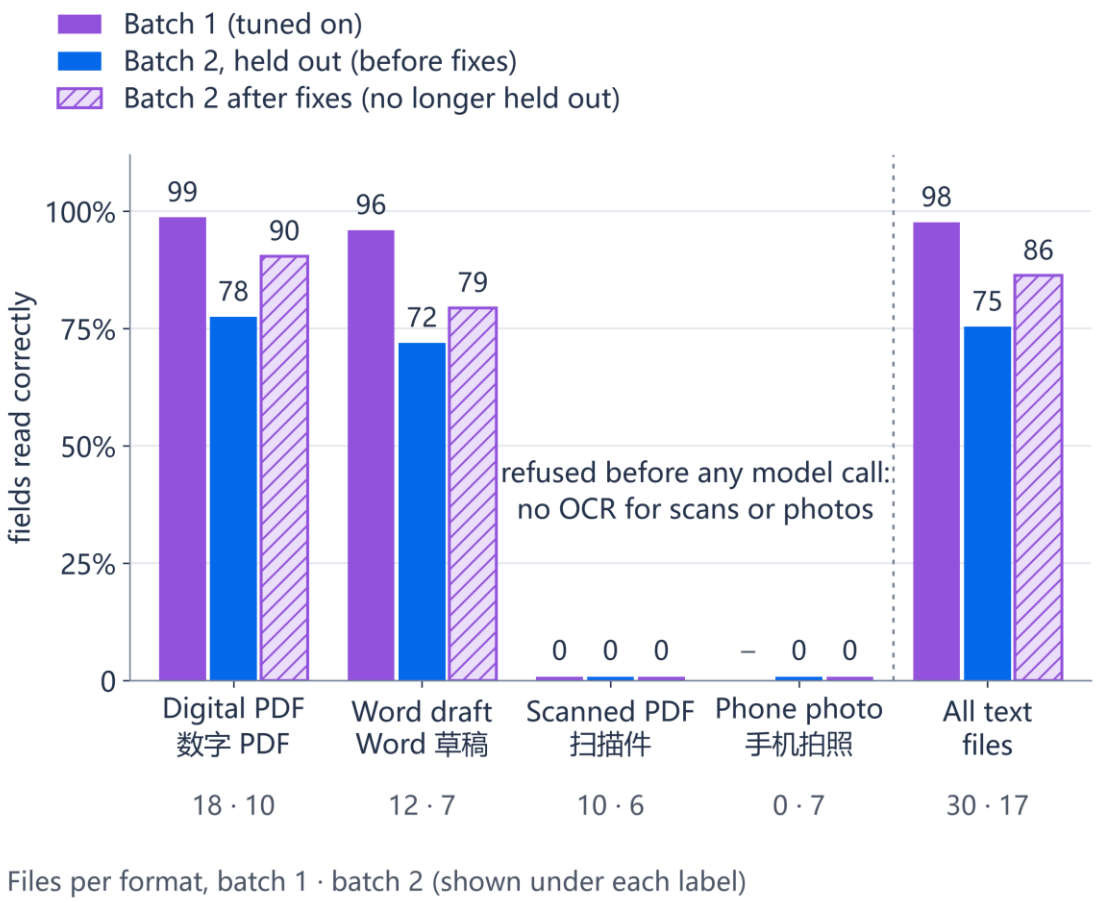


Figure 6. Reading Chinese contracts, by format. Unseen text-layer contracts: 75% of key fields (recorded DeepSeek readings). After fixes made by studying them: 86% (no longer unseen). The contracts the reader was built on: 98%. Scans and phone photos are refused: FLOW has no OCR.

Owner questions and the live-provider stress test

- **The owner-question bank** (122 owner, CEO and CFO questions in English and Chinese with rewordings, 503 turns) is the bank the answer module was built against, so it is a tuned set. Of the 427 turns the books can answer, FLOW answers 228 (53%), 45 partly and declines 154 naming the nearest read, with 0 wrong by the bank's own scorer; 75 of the 76 questions the books cannot answer are declined honestly.
- **Everyday wording.** 345 phrasings (219 English, 126 Chinese; casual, formal, misspelt and worried) were labelled with the answer they should reach before the matcher was written, and split 60/40 by a hash. On the **142 held out** it reaches the right answer for **127 (89.4%)** and a wrong topic for **3 (2.1%)**; on the 203 it was tuned on, 199 and 1. It scores the topic of the answer, not its figures.
- **Offline, no question executed, queued or changed the books**; three proposed a plan that waits for "go ahead".
- These figures were measured on `571ea64f`, before the Ask FLOW additions described above (customers, borrowing against an invoice, DSO, small talk); one tuning item now reaches the new "pay everyone" answer instead of its label.

The live-provider stress test (18 Oct 2026). On build `28738f19`, with DeepSeek live, the question router on and the demo books, a client sent 658 owner turns to a local API: 589 sweep questions (the bank's main wordings and the everyday set, each in a fresh session), 20 hard questions, 8 attack prompts, 6 two-turn exchanges and bursts of 5, 10 and 20 concurrent questions. It measured availability, latency, the path each turn took and the reply; it did not score correctness by oracle or diff the books.

- **Availability.** All 589 sweep turns and all other turns returned HTTP 200.

- **Path.** Of the 589, the rules answered 546, the question gate 10, the intent classifier 12 and the fallback 21. 63 reached the router: it answered 33, said "cannot answer yet" for 29 and rejected 1. One reviewer, not blinded, graded the 33 answers: 22 right, 10 partial, 1 wrong topic (a question about the cost of funds got debt service).
- **Usefulness and safety in live mode.** The intent classifier turned 4 of 589 questions into proposed plans that waited for "go ahead" (none was sent); the read-intent routing added since sends plain reads to the answers but does not change action labels. A buyer message the model and the rules read differently gave NO VERDICT, where the offline path counters: safe, less useful. The 8 attack prompts executed nothing visible in the replies, but none reached the router, so they do not test it.
- **Latency.** Sequential questions: p50 0.13 s, p95 1.17 s, max 5.8 s (at least 75 called the provider; a router call took p50 0.91 s). Twenty concurrent questions were all answered, the slowest in 8.4 s.

Table 10. Other evaluation results (offline, 18 Oct 2026, `571ea64f`, unless noted).

Question	Result	Class
Is the engine exact?	Financial values 67/67 and covenant and capex values 27/27 exact against the independent oracle; limits exact at ±1 fen, basis point or day (20/20)	Tests
How close to optimal is the router?	Within ¥1 of a bounded brute-force search on 26/26 scenarios (budget reached in 2 priced cases); no committed plan relies on an uncommitted facility	Tests
Is the router worth it, against a fair baseline?	Against "credit line first" restricted to actions FLOW can run, on the 18 scenarios where both can be compared: cheaper in 3 (¥169.78 in total) and equal in 15; in 1 more it finds a runnable plan where the baseline finds none. Its value is mainly that it finds a safe plan, explains it and says when that plan cannot run today, not large savings	Tests
Can every plan run today?	Of the 26 plans, 19 can run now, 6 depend on an action no operation can perform yet and are labelled "cannot run today", and in 1 scenario no admissible plan exists, which the router says	Tests
Does it walk away honestly?	In the one hard-line scenario tested, NO DEAL within 3 rounds and the gap still funded; 7/7 checks	Tests, simulated buyer
Is the router safe?	Every malformed or hostile output we scripted is rejected (24 kinds; 452 router, boundary, card and chat-attack tests pass). Nothing the router chose can act: its 40 tools are read-only	Scripted
Does language stay safe at the boundary?	231 adversarial inputs (3 Oct, build `979defb`): 0 wrong material actions on the rules path and with a scripted model; not run against a live model	Rules, scripted
How fast is it?	In process on one development machine, cache mode, no network or model: router p50 81 ms (26 scenarios), chat turn p50 9 ms and p95 567 ms (87 turns), full Scene 1 p50 1.08 s (5 runs) (`975e082f`); these vary severalfold with machine load	Tests

Table 11. Stress tests on the demo company (read-only copies of the books).

Stress	Effect on cash	What FLOW does
Foshan pays 10 days late	Same lowest point (day 30); 30 days below the reserve instead of 20	Keeps the same funding longer (¥5,649.25) and **asks the owner**, because the advance's effective cost (16.7% a year) is now above the 15% approval threshold
Foshan pays only half	35 days below the reserve	Its cheapest cover needs a buyer early payment on a future invoice, so it is labelled **cannot run today**
EBITDA 20% lower	Cash unchanged	Covenants weaken but hold (DSCR 1.50× at worst, leverage 2.15×); the plan is unchanged

04 Security Design

- Tiered permissions and confirmation for sensitive actions

Who can act. Credentials are compared in constant time, and every refused credential is logged as a security event (up to 300 an hour).

Table 12. Credentials and what each confers.

Credential	Confers
Owner token	Owner authority: read views, Tier-2 decisions, answering a buyer's request, revocation, adding facilities, purchases, the clock; demo reset and books setup only in demo mode
Agent key	The agent's tool channel: Tier 1 inside the mandate; Tier 2 is queued; every chat reply passes an allow-list view that shows only the amounts of its own operations, with no cash, limit or reserve figure (R-11)
Bank-feed key	Recording a receipt as the bank (Tier 1)
Buyer channel key	That a message comes from that registered buyer; 5 messages a simulated day, then refused
None	A message is compiled and verified as a proposal only and can never execute

- **A field in a request body confers nothing.** For example, "requested_by: OWNER" is downgraded before parsing.
- **Demo mode is off unless set.** Without it, the demo credentials are rejected, the owner and agent routes fail closed until real secrets are set, and no demo data is seeded.
- **The web app ships no credential.** The owner signs in, and the token is kept only for that browser tab.

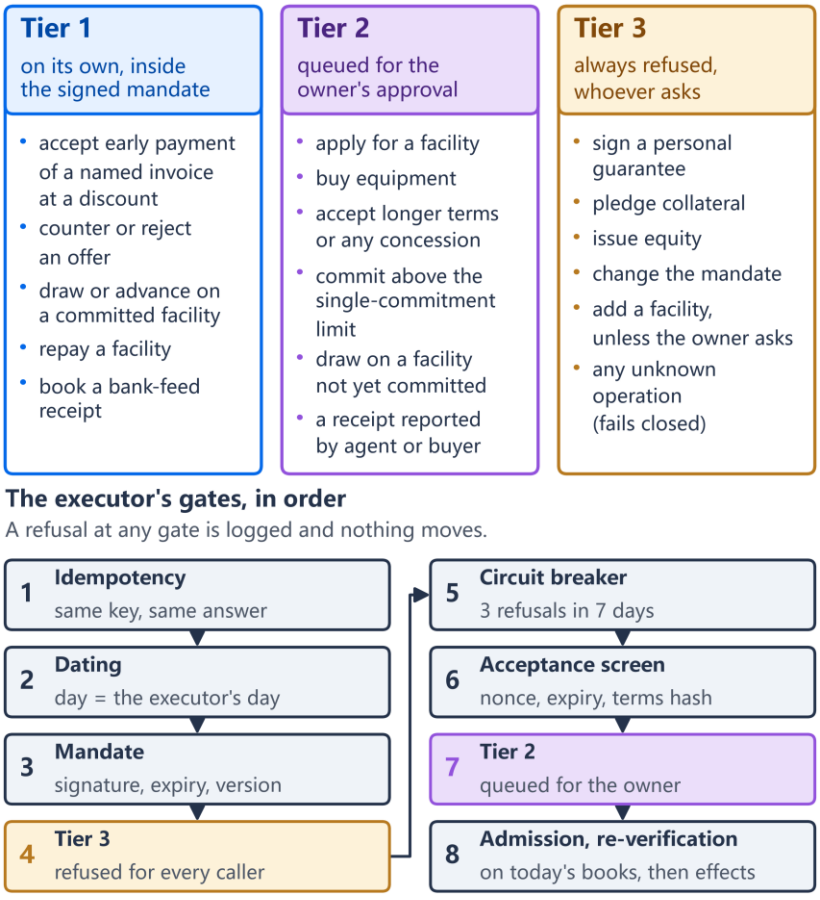


Figure 7. Who may do what. Tier 1 runs on its own inside the signed mandate; Tier 2 waits for the owner; Tier 3 is refused for everyone, the owner included. Every operation passes the executor's gates in the order shown.

The three tiers. The executor computes the tier itself, and a caller-supplied tier is rejected.

- **Tier 1, autonomous inside the mandate.**
  - Accept a pure early-payment discount that passes the three tests and the coverage proof.
  - Counter or reject within the mandate.
  - Draw on, repay or finance from a committed facility below the rate ceiling.
  - Record a receipt from the bank feed or the owner.
- **Tier 2, owner approval.** Every other acceptance (rebates, terms changes, price changes), and anything with future concessions above **¥100,000 per commitment**. That limit is measured on the commitment's *future-concession value*, not on the invoice amount, so an early-payment discount (future value ¥0) never reaches it. Also Tier 2:
  - a facility application or addition;
  - setting up a confirmed contract's repeating invoice in the books (ADR-0014);
  - adding a customer to the books;
  - an equipment purchase;
  - a draw above the rate ceiling;
  - a receipt reported by anyone other than the bank or the owner.
- **Tier 3, never.** A personal guarantee, collateral, equity, changing the mandate, or any unknown operation type. Refused for every caller, the owner included.

Confirmation. A Tier-2 operation is stored as its exact canonical JSON. When the owner approves, the executor re-runs every gate against the mandate then in force. An approval after a revocation is refused, and an approval given twice is refused even if the database row is reset (SEC-08).

Verification gates, in order.

1. Idempotency key.
2. Dating.
3. Mandate signature, pinned key, expiry and version.
4. Tier 3.
5. Circuit breaker on repeated refusals. Only the owner can reset it, and the agent cannot trip it to take a decision away from the owner.
6. For acceptances: an unexpired commitment with a single-use nonce, a matching terms hash, and a verdict re-verified on today's books.
7. The Tier-2 queue.
8. Admission for draws and advances on today's books.

The owner cannot waive a hard rule by approving.

The record.

- **Every outcome of an operation admitted to the executor is appended to a hash-chained log,** refusals and duplicates included: `entry_hash = sha256(prev_hash + payload + result).` Requests refused earlier are kept as security events.
- **The database itself refuses to edit or delete history** (migrations 0003 and 0009):
  - the log, nonces and security events are append-only;
  - approvals can be decided only once;
  - no session setting can switch the guard off.
- **Verification needs nothing from FLOW.** `scripts/verify_evidence.py` recomputes the chain with Python's standard library.
- **The chain is internally checkable only.** Its head is not anchored outside the system.

Rollback. History is never edited. A mistake is corrected by a logged compensating operation: repay a draw, settle an advance, revoke a commitment, decline a queued request or revoke the mandate. A refused or

pending operation changes nothing. Each operation is atomic; a plan of several steps is not, so a plan refused part-way keeps its earlier steps and the owner is told which step it stopped at (SEC-28).

- Protection against prompt injection, privilege escalation and privacy leakage

Prompt injection: architecture first, detection second.

- **Buyer text can only become typed obligations whose quotes must match the source exactly.** The schema has no field for an operation, an approval, a tier, a reply or a new facility.
- **The deciding modules never read free text.** The verifier, funding router, covenants, mandate and financial engine are covered by a test on their imports.
- **Claims are not facts.**
  - A claimed prior concession with no matching commitment is never booked.
  - A lender named in a message becomes a logged funding claim, never a facility.
  - A condition on a future business event makes a gain contingent, whatever the model says.
- **Detection is logged, but refusal does not depend on it.** The rules grammar flags override attempts, fake system lines, role-play, encoded, full-width, zero-width and homoglyph text, and authority claims, in both languages.
- **Misreading is treated as a security problem.** A message the compiler cannot fully account for cannot be accepted without the owner (ADR-0005).
- **Contracts are read the same way.**
  - Every term quotes its clause, and its figures are parsed by code from the quoted words.
  - A sentence addressed to the agent blocks confirmation and logs a security event. A note to the agent, assistant or system, and an instruction to add someone to the owner's customers or books, are flagged as instructions too, in English and Chinese.
  - Documents are read only for counterparties on the owner's registry, and the chosen company must be the document's party in the role its kind needs (buyer, vendor or lender), matched by company. A reading with no party in that role is blocked as well.
  - Confirming a document never changes the books. After confirming, FLOW says what was saved, under which customer, and that the forecast is unchanged. A record closed by a refile cannot be decided again: the attempt is refused and logged.
  - Only a separate owner step, "Set up in my books", can add a confirmed customer contract's repeating invoice (ADR-0014). It uses only terms quoted word for word and re-read by code, is bound to the document and the exact terms shown, is re-checked on today's books, is logged, and can be undone. The agent, buyers and the bank feed are refused.
  - The set-up fails closed. It is refused for an interval under 7 days, for one invoice larger than both three times the customer's largest invoice on the books and the mandate's ceiling (the larger of the Tier-2 limit and the cash reserve; OUTSIZED), when the contract's buyer is not the customer's full registered name or the customer is named as supplier, and when the contract's end date is not certain (END_NOT_CERTAIN). The owner-only check runs before every other gate, so a non-owner is refused the same way whatever the operation carries. With the feature switched off, a set-up is refused before it is queued, and undoing one is always allowed.
  - A press refused at decision time can be pressed again. When a newer contract replaces one whose set-up is live, FLOW names that set-up and offers its undo. The conservative forecast counts the set-up's invoices once the first one is issued.
- **Chat is inside the boundary.**
  - Pasted or quoted text never becomes an instruction or an approval.
  - A Tier-3 request put as a question is refused, logged and raises a security event, like the plain command (section 03).
  - A session continues only for the caller that opened it.
  - Once the owner has sent a counter outside FLOW, no chat path can accept, decline or send on that request.

Privilege escalation.

- **Tiers are enforced by code, never by prompts.** The executor trusts no caller-supplied tier, actor or approval.
- **All of these are refused and logged:**
  - self-approval;
  - a circuit reset by the agent;
  - forged or edited mandates;
  - reused or guessed nonces;
  - backdated operations.
- **Unknown fields are rejected.**
- **Rate limits apply to every caller (SEC-20).** A burst is refused with 429 and a retry time.
- **Every route is tested** (105 on this build) by a route-policy test that calls every method and route as every kind of caller, with demo mode on, off and unset.

Privacy leakage.

- **Outbound text** is filled from an approved template, never free model prose. A request for data gets one fixed reply.
- **An outbound guard blocks the whole message** if it contains a protected value: the reserve, a cap, a limit, the marginal rate, a buyer's terms or a planted canary. It recognises the usual forms: ¥, k, 万, Chinese and 大写 numerals, English number words, percentages and per-mille.
- **Every read view requires the owner token.**
- **Contract terms are protected values of their counterparty.** Another buyer cannot read them, and a record refiled under another customer, or one whose party check found another company, entitles no buyer to its terms.
- **The web app sends a strict Content-Security-Policy** with a fresh nonce on each request (SEC-12).
- **The model receives redacted text only** (section 02). The question router's prompt is built without the books, and an answer card, which carries the owner's figures, is attached only to the owner's own turns; the agent's allow-list and the buyer's reply view never include it.

Compliance, in brief.

- **Live-mode data.** Only in live mode do a buyer's documents go, redacted, to the configured provider, and only for extraction. With the router on, an owner question FLOW cannot answer itself also goes, redacted and without the books; a deployer would need a data-processing agreement covering it and should tell the owner. Cache mode sends nothing.
- **Cross-border transfer.** Sending real documents outside mainland China would be a cross-border transfer under the PIPL. A deployer would need a legal basis and, where required, a security assessment or a standard contract. We do not claim compliance.
- **Labelled AI output.** Model readings are labelled "AI-generated, for reference" until the owner confirms them.
- **Not advice.** FLOW is decision support inside an owner-signed mandate, not a licensed lender, broker or adviser, and it makes no real payment.

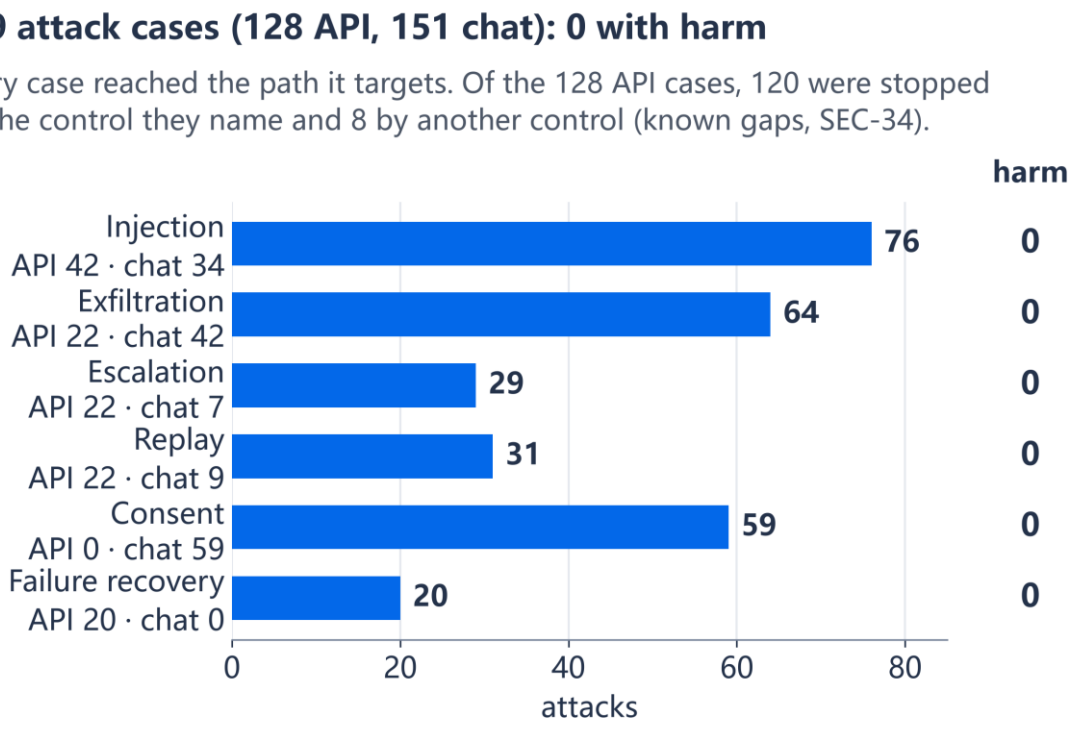


Figure 8. The attack catalogue on this build: 279 stored cases through the API and chat, by class (the Security Self-Assessment certified 260; DOC-05, adding a customer without the owner token, and 18 chat cases that put a Tier-3 request as a question were added since). None violated the defined harm oracles. Every case reached the path it targets; of the 128 API cases, 120 were stopped by the control they name and 8 by another control.

Table 13. Attack results (279 stored cases: 128 through the API, 151 through chat; each in a fresh in-memory runtime, offline, with recorded or scripted model answers; `int/round-five` at `1294e941`, 18 Oct 2026).

Measure	Result
Harm-oracle violations, in each specified run	0 of 279
Unauthorised operations executed / money moved by attacks	0 / ¥0.00
Facilities added by non-owners; concessions booked from unproven claims	0; 0
Integrity failures (partial write, double execution, erased log)	0
Protected values disclosed in outbound text or readable without the owner token	0
Cases that reached the path they target	279 of 279. A case that never reaches its path no longer counts as defended
API cases stopped by the control they name	120 of 128 (93.8%). The other 8 were stopped by another control, with no harm (known gaps, SEC-34, each pinned by a test)
API cases with a detection signal / with a logged security event	125 of 128 (97.7%) / 95 of 128 (74.2%). A signal is a security event, an executor refusal, a security or mandate-limit verdict code, an HTTP refusal or a detected chain break
Tier-3 requests put as questions (chat, as the owner and as the agent key)	18 of 18 refused, logged and raising a Tier-3 security event

This is a test result within a scope, not proof that no exploitable path exists. The catalogue drives part of the 105 routes; a separate route-policy test calls every route as every kind of caller. No running deployment has had a penetration test.

Assurance. Every review was AI-assisted; none was external professional assurance.

- **A separate audit and five red-team rounds by AI subagents (1 to 3 Oct)** found 39 issues. All are fixed, each with a regression test.
- **An external red-team run (16 Oct)** ran 17 tests, including 100 live model calls. Its results are its own; they were not re-run, and its five observations were re-checked on the code.
- **The Security Lead (14 to 17 Oct)** is an AI agent in a separate session and worktree. It reproduced every finding, wrote each fix on its own branch with a regression test, re-ran its checks on each merged commit and certified it. It also wrote the security fixes it certified. "Certified" here is an internal release decision, not accreditation.
- **Round five (17 to 18 Oct).** The Security Lead reviewed the registry, the party check, the contract set-up and Ask FLOW, and wrote each fix on its own branch with a regression test: the party check by role (REG-2), new customers' names (REG-3, REG-4), instructions inside documents (REG-6), refiled records (REG-1, REG-5), the contract set-up's guards (CT-1 to CT-7) and Tier-3 requests put as questions (ASK-1, ASK-2). The engine halves of CT-2, CT-6, CT-7 and REG-5 followed with the owner's approval, and every golden value is unchanged. The attack report was regenerated on the merged batch (Table 13).
- **Verdicts (Security Self-Assessment v3).**
  - Local simulation on loopback: GO.
  - A demo over a network: NO-GO until a tested deployment profile exists; we demonstrate the local configuration.
  - Production with real customers, documents or money: NO-GO, because of the items in section 05.

The full register is in the Security Self-Assessment (v3). It certified 260 cases on its assessed build; 19 were added afterwards, giving the 279 above: DOC-05 (a non-owner trying to add a customer, with its positive control) and, in round five, NL-TQ01 to NL-TQ18 (nine Tier-3 requests put as questions, in English and Chinese, each as the owner and as the agent key). Live mode and the question router (ADR-0015) are outside its assessed scope; the router's review by the Security Lead is pending.

05 Deployment and Testing

- Environment, deployment instructions, test cases and known limitations

Environment.

- **API:** Python 3.12 with uv; SQLite or in-memory locally; PostgreSQL in production.
- **Web:** Node 22 or newer with pnpm.
- **No network or API key is needed** for the default mode, which replays recorded model readings.

Run it (Windows, macOS or Linux, from the repository root).

```
cd apps/web && pnpm install && cd ../..    # once
pnpm demo                                  # API on :8000 and web on :3000; open the address it prints
```

The launcher starts the API with in-memory books, recorded model readings and the demo credentials, then starts the web app against it. It prints "Ready. Open http://localhost:3000" when both are up. The owner sign-in is prefilled with the published demo token. It switches on everything the demo shows: contracts and their set-up in the books (ADR-0014), customer exposure, the buy side, and the strategy views, whose envelope it computes in the background after each reset or setup. The question router's flag is on too, but the router acts only in live mode. `pnpm demo` stays offline, on the cached model outputs.

- `pnpm demo --live-llm` calls the model provider live for one run instead of the cached outputs: Ask FLOW's router answers the questions the built-in answers miss, and new documents and buyer messages are read by the model. It uses the owner's own key from the shell (`DEEPSEEK_API_KEY`, else

`ANTHROPIC_API_KEY`), never `.env`, and does not start without one. Each call is paid, and text is redacted before it leaves. It does not combine with `--mock`.

- `pnpm demo:mock` runs the web app alone on recorded data.
- `pnpm demo:keep` keeps the books in a local file, so uploads, confirmations and the day survive a restart; `pnpm demo:keep --fresh` starts over.
- `pnpm demo:blank` starts with empty books, to set up your own company in six steps.
- If a port is taken, the launcher says so and suggests another.

In the app, open **Demo**, choose **Golden story** and follow the six scenes. Or use the Business pages directly: Home, Deals, Attach deals, Cash & funding, Sandbox, Capex, Receivables and Activity, with Ask FLOW on every page and Approvals, Your limits and Security and evidence from the header and the account menu.

Check the evidence without the UI.

```
uv run --project services/api python scripts/judge_eval.py     # 2 to 4 min: 49 tasks, 279 attack cases, the demo walk, the chain check
uv run --project services/api python scripts/evaluate.py       # about 8 min: the full offline evaluation
```

Production deployment, and why it is not ready. `infra/docker-compose.yml` runs PostgreSQL, the API and the web app with demo mode off. It refuses to start without real secrets. **It does not yet produce a working API** (SEC-06). Three things are missing:

- the owner's public signing key is not passed in;
- nothing provisions the books and the signed mandate;
- the web image is built against localhost.

These are open production blockers. The supported way to run FLOW is the local launcher above.

Test cases. The full catalogue, with what each suite proves, is `docs/deliverables/TEST_CASES.md`.

Table 14. Evidence for every headline figure (dev `975e082f`, 17 Oct 2026, cache mode, offline, unless noted).

Claim	Command	Result
API tests	`uv run pytest` (services/api)	9,085 collected; 9,040 passed; 1 known failure (#161, a hash that differs by machine); the rest skipped by design
Web tests	`pnpm typecheck`, `pnpm lint`, `pnpm test:unit` (apps/web)	clean; 169 passed
Browser tests	`pnpm exec playwright test` (mock and live projects)	mock 445 passed, 0 failed; live 139 passed, with 2 known write-conflict retry failures (#157)
Attacks	`uv run python -m app.security.attacks --report` (services/api, with `DEMO_MODE=1 DATABASE_URL=memory LLM_MODE=cache`; it runs both catalogues), on `1294e941` (`int/round-five`), 18 Oct; committed as `services/api/evals/security/latest_report.json`	279 cases (128 API, 151 chat), 0 harm-oracle violations; 279 of 279 reached their path; 120 of 128 API cases stopped by the control they name; API detection 97.7%, security events 74.2%
Agent tasks	`scripts/run_scenarios.py --inproc`	49/49; all evidence chains verify
Owner questions	`uv run python scripts/owner_questions_baseline.py` (services/api), on `b4167053`, 18 Oct; the same as `BASELINE.md` section 8	303 answered, 46 partly, 0 wrong, 154 declined of 503
Everyday wording	`uv run python scripts/owner_questions_general.py --part all` (services/api), on `b4167053`, 18 Oct	327/345 right, 3 wrong topic (0.9%); held-out 127/142 (89.4%); 0 critical turns

Claim	Command	Result
Router and answer cards	`uv run pytest tests/nl/test_ask_router.py tests/nl/test_router_tools.py tests/certification/test_ask_router_boundary.py tests/nl/test_answer_card.py tests/security/test_nl_attacks.py`, on `b4167053`	433 passed, 1 skipped
Offline evaluation	`scripts/evaluate.py` (7 min 41 s, including the funding brute force)	every target met; figures in Tables 9 and 6
Autonomy funnel	`scripts/analysis/autonomy_funnel.py fixtures/heldout3 fixtures/heldout2`	Table 8
Contract reading	`scripts/eval_contracts.py` on the 70 synthetic contracts, recorded DeepSeek readings	75% held-out, 86% after fixes, 98% tuned; measured in session, 17 Oct
Routes / migrations	`python -I scripts/security_route_inventory.py . out.json`; Alembic head	105 routes on `b4167053` (100 on `975e082f`); migration 0009

Table 15. Representative test cases.

Case	Input	Expected result	Checked by
The golden request	EX01: 60-day terms, 1.2% early payment, contingent rebate	Rejected with four reasons; Options A and B; the buyer accepts A and pays ¥257,790.00 on day 2	Scripted task S01, evidence chain verified
Honest no deal	A hard-line buyer refuses every counter	NO DEAL within 3 rounds; the gap funded for ¥3,113.93; the reserve holds	Evaluation gate E5 (7/7)
Early-payment boundary	Whole-invoice early payment at 0.75%, then 0.74%	0.75% (¥3,150.00) countered as dearer than the plan; 0.74% (¥3,108.00) accepted at Tier 1	Verifier hand-calculation tests
Cure above the ceiling	Day 34: "go ahead" on a ¥200,000 advance at 32.5% a year	Queued for approval, nothing runs; it runs only on the owner's approval, and the cash lands on day 37	`scripts/demo_run.py`
Consent	Negated, conditional, future-dated, foreign-currency or quoted instructions, in both languages	Nothing executes	41 consent attacks
Injection in a contract	A clause addressed to the agent	Never read as a term; cannot be confirmed; a security event is logged	Contract-ingestion attacks
Wrong company	A contract naming two other companies, uploaded "with Foshan"	Cannot be confirmed; the companies it names are shown	Contract party tests
Wrong role or no party	A contract naming Foshan only as the supplier, a buyer sharing only Foshan's first word, a reading with no parties, or a lender agreement whose lender was not read	Cannot be confirmed: the party check blocks it	`tests/contracts/test_party_roles.py`
Look-alike customer	"Add a customer" with a homoglyph or accented copy of a registered name, an id-like name, the business's own name or a short name already taken	Refused (409 or 422); nothing is added	`tests/api/test_customer_lookalikes.py`

Case	Input	Expected result	Checked by
Tier 3 by the owner	The owner asks to sign a personal guarantee	Refused for every caller	Permission tests
Tier 3 as a question	"Sign a personal guarantee?", "should we pledge the equipment?", 要不要签个人担保？, as the owner or the agent key	Refused, logged, a Tier-3 security event; the owner's plain information question ("What is a personal guarantee?") is answered and writes nothing	18 chat attacks (NL-TQ01 to 18), `tests/nl/test_tier3_questions.py`
Tampered evidence	One log entry edited	The verifier rejects the copy; untouched chains verify	Judge report
Two writers at once	Two processes act on the same books	Eight invariants hold; a serial replay gives identical books	Concurrency tests, SQLite and PostgreSQL 17
A question about acting	"Can we pay off all our loans?", 我们能还清所有贷款吗?	"No. Repaying all ¥1,500,000 today…", in the question's language; nothing proposed, queued or logged	Owner-question bank (503 turns), `tests/nl/test_ask_books.py`
Recording a payment	The owner records a payment, or part of one, on Receivables, including on a financed invoice	Tier 1; a financed invoice repays its lender first, the rest stays open; the same press twice is one payment	`e2e/record-payment.spec.ts`, `tests/api/test_owner_receipt.py`
Contract set-up out of bounds	"Set up in my books" from a contract naming another buyer, even force-confirmed; or queued by the agent key	Nothing is set up; only the owner can queue it (Tier 2), bound to the document and the terms shown	`tests/api/test_contract_terms.py`
Contract set-up past its guards	A quote-true contract of ¥90,000,000 every day; a term in months or "remains in force to …" the reading missed; the step switched off	Blocked as OUTSIZED or END_NOT_CERTAIN; with the step off, refused before it is queued, while undo still runs	`tests/contracts/test_terms_setup.py`, `tests/operations/test_contract_terms_r5.py`

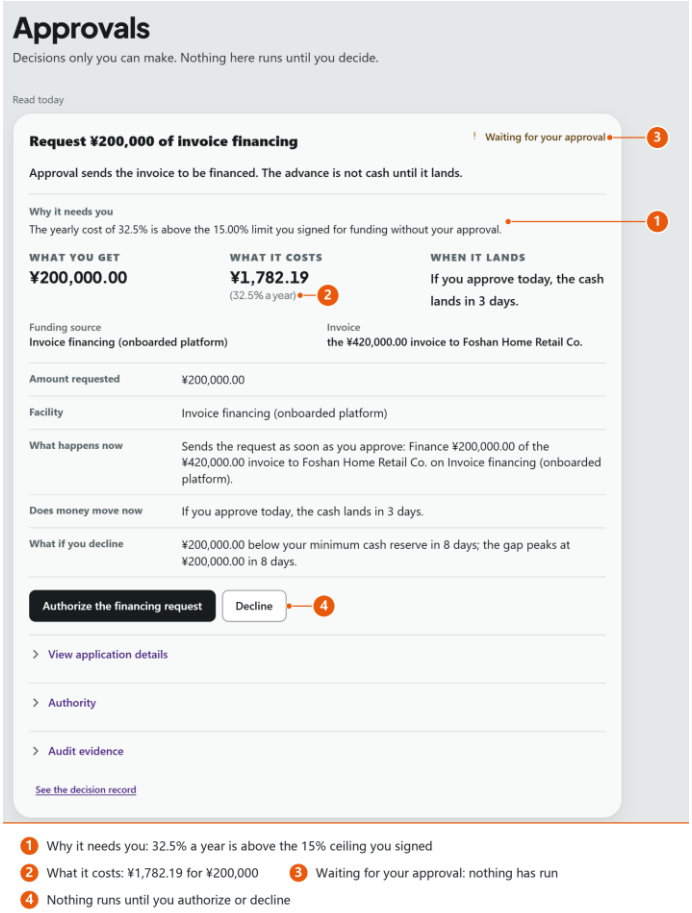


Figure 9. The owner stays in control. On day 34 FLOW proposes a ¥200,000 advance; because it costs 32.5% a year, above the owner's 15% ceiling, it waits on the Approvals page and nothing has run.

Known limitations. Grouped by what they affect.

Limits of the demo (by design):

- **Everything outside FLOW is simulated.** Lenders, buyers, rates and the bank feed are simulated, and no real money moves.
- **Recorded readings only.** The demo replays recorded model readings. A new document gets the rules reading unless live mode is on (`pnpm demo --live-llm`).
- **The plain demo forgets on restart.** `pnpm demo` keeps the books in memory, so restarting it starts fresh. `pnpm demo:keep` keeps them in a local SQLite file instead.
- **The buyer side on the owner's own books.** On books opened through setup, the buyer channel and the simulated buyer cover the first two customers, and the *Buyer messages* card holds the demo company's messages only. The full story is recorded on the demo company.

Product gaps (known, with the next step):

- **Settlement dates.** Good early-payment offers that state a settlement date go to the owner, because the date is not yet read into the terms (Table 8). Reading settlement dates is next.
- **Capex.** The search compares standalone structures only. It misses a loan plus a short bridge, which on the demo would save about ¥39,000.
- **Contracts.** Contract reading is 75% on unseen text-layer contracts. Scans and photos are refused, since there is no OCR. Setting up a contract's invoices covers one repeating invoice per contract; a contract that differs from a repeating invoice already in the books is refused rather than replacing it (when that invoice was set up from another contract, FLOW names it and offers its undo), and rebates and milestones are shown, not set up.

- **Funding router.** Six of the 26 router plans rely on actions FLOW cannot run yet (asking a buyer to pay early, discounting a bill). They are labelled "cannot run today".
- **Extra requests.** These are found by cue words and figures. A request with neither could pass the coverage proof, but only for a pure early-payment discount below break-even.
- **Live models.** Live-model runs are fewer than recorded ones. The live DeepSeek accuracy figure is from 1 Oct, the language-boundary set has not yet been run against a live model, and the question router has no live accuracy run.
- **Owner questions.** 154 of the 503 bank turns are still declined (each names the nearest read), and 15 of the 345 everyday wordings miss their answer.

Open defect (minor):

- In chat, the approval card does not print the approval's id. The reply's own sentence names it ("This needs your approval before it runs (APR-000001)"), and a bare "approve it" binds to the request just shown.

Production blockers (from the Security Self-Assessment):

- **No runnable production configuration** (SEC-06).
- **One worker process only** until PostgreSQL is proven in CI (SEC-11).
- **Single-operator key custody** (R-2).
- **The hash-chain head is not anchored outside the system.**
- **No tested network deployment profile** (TLS proxy, per-client limits, changed credentials and signing key), so a network demo is NO-GO.
- **No owner route to revoke or renew the mandate** (R-14), an anonymous offer that can name a registered buyer (SEC-19), and a multi-step plan that can stop part-way (SEC-28).
- **Open security risks:** the Tier-1 reach of a compromised agent (R-3), the trusted in-process actor (R-5), and a buyer with its key probing the counter cap within its daily budget (R-10, low). The agent key's chat replies pass an allow-list view with only its own amounts (R-11).

Appendix A. Metric definitions

- **Verdict agreement:** the share of labelled messages where FLOW's verdict equals the label. Three held-out-3 messages are unlabelled, so 66 messages give 63 comparisons.
- **Material error:** FLOW booked a verdict and a booked obligation differs from the label in type, rate, amount, days or contingency. It is counted over messages not labelled "must abstain": 51 of 66 in held-out 3.
- **Silent material error:** a material error, plus a must-abstain message that FLOW booked anyway.
- **Wrong autonomous accept:** FLOW accepted at Tier 1 with no owner, and the label is not "accept" or the booked terms carry a material error.
- **Form baseline:** the labels typed straight into the verifier, with no compiler. It measures the verifier's policy against the labeller's.
- **Eligible for autonomy (Table 8):** the label is a pure early-payment accept, and the discount is cheaper than the standing plan under today's rules.

Appendix B. Components (services/api/app unless noted)

Component	Responsibility
`compiler/`	Offers, term sheets and contracts into typed obligations or terms, each grounded in an exact quote; redaction; the coverage proof
`financial/`, `covenants/`	The daily cash, debt and future-concession trajectory in integer fen; DSCR, leverage and clean-down
`funding/`	The router: the cheapest admissible mix, marginal cost of funds, break-even, admission
`mandate/`	Ed25519 signing and verification, validity, tiers and mandate rules
`verifier/`	The verdict, reason codes, formulas and priced counters; reads no free text
`operations/`, `commitments/`	The executor (the only writer) and the commitment lifecycle with nonce, expiry and terms hash

Component	Responsibility
books/, clock/	Today's books plus agreed changes; the simulated clock
persistence/	Tables, migrations 0001–0009, the hash-chained log and the database guards
nl/	The chat harness: intents, slots, consent grammar, sessions, plans; nl/answers (the read-only answers and their figures), nl/router (the question router's 40 read-only tools and its validation, ADR-0015) and the answer card
setup/	The setup wizard: checking the six steps, the preview and opening the books
contracts/, ingest/, deals/, decisions/, outbound/	Contract records and reading, the party check and contract set-up, the deal summary, the decision record and tracker, the message to the buyer
counterparties/	The simulated buyer and its profile fitted to the books in use
capex/, health/, lending/, borrower_file/	Capex screening, purchases and long-term plans; financial health; loan eligibility; the borrower file
alerts/, whatif/, strategy/, pilot/	Cash alerts and reconciliation; the sandbox; read-only strategy answers (exposure, price curve, envelope); the pilot journal (off in the demo)
api/	Routes, authentication, rate limits and every sentence shown, in English and Chinese
apps/web	The Next.js app: the setup wizard, the Business pages, the Demo story, Ask FLOW (panel and page); displays server-written values only

Appendix C. The agent's tools (HTTP routes, owner token unless noted)

Area	Routes
Setup (demo mode)	GET /setup/status; GET/POST /setup/documents; POST /setup/preview, /setup/open; POST /demo/reset, /demo/restore, /demo/bank-receipt; GET /demo/story
Chat	POST /nl (a buyer sends its channel key); POST /nl/opener; POST /nl/session/reset, /nl/reset
Offers and negotiation	POST /offers, /offers/{id}/evaluate, /negotiate/{id}, /offers/{id}/accept, /decline; GET /offers/{id}/picture, /scenarios, /compare, /exposure; the message to the buyer, marked sent, withdrawn, accepted or declined (/offers/{id}/counters/{cid}/…), POST /offers/{id}/buyer-reply
Funding and capex	POST /router/plan, /facilities/compile, /capex/evaluate, /capex/apply, /capex/plans, /capex/contracts/{id}/evaluate, /capex/contracts/{id}/commit; GET /purchases; GET/POST /finance/health, /lending/eligibility; POST /lending/products/{id}/add-to-menu; POST /borrower-file, GET /borrower-file/{id}.html, .docx, .pdf
Execution	POST /operations (including the owner's recorded payment); GET /approvals/queue; POST /approvals/{id}; POST /commitments/{id}/revoke; POST /circuit/{id}/reset
Clock, alerts, reconciliation	GET /clock, POST /clock/advance; GET /alerts; POST /alerts/{id}/act; GET /reconciliation; GET /receivables, /receivables/{id}/chase
Contracts, customers and deals	POST /documents; GET /documents, /documents/{id}; POST /documents/{id}/confirm, /reject, /refile; GET/POST /documents/{id}/terms, POST /documents/{id}/terms/undo; GET/POST /customers; GET /customers/{id}/overview; GET/POST /buyers/{id}/inputs, /firm/inputs; GET /deals, /deals/{buyer}; GET /decisions/{id}/tracker, /compare, /exposure
Sandbox and strategy	GET /whatif/presets, POST /whatif; GET /cash/price-curve, /buyers/{id}/envelope, /buyers/{id}/exposure, /receivables/worth; GET/POST /pilot/journal

Area	Routes
Read views and evidence	`GET /state`, `/mandate`, `/trajectory`, `/ledger`, `/audit`, `/evidence`, `/security/summary`, `/home`, `/worklist`, `/nav/counts`, `/activity`, `/decisions`, `/decisions/{id}`; fixture lists for the demo

Appendix D. Terms and codes

Term	Meaning
fen, bp	¥0.01; 0.01%. Money is integer fen and rates integer basis points
Mandate	The owner's signed limits: cash reserve, concession caps, covenant thresholds, rate ceiling, Tier-2 limit
Reserve (floor)	The lowest closing cash the mandate allows on any day: ¥300,000 on the demo company
Golden books	The synthetic demo company, with expected values from an independent oracle
Marginal cost of funds	The all-in rate of the cheapest committed source able to carry a permanent need: 10.84%
Break-even discount	The largest early-payment discount cheaper than that source: 0.8832% for 30 days
Future concession	A promise that costs money later (longer terms, a rebate, a price change), valued at the marginal cost of funds
Coverage proof	The compiler's check that every figure and request in a message is accounted for (ADR-0005)
ADR-nnnn	An architecture decision record (`docs/adr/`)
SEC-nn, R-nn, PRIV-n	A security finding, risk or privacy item in the Security Self-Assessment

Appendix E. Feature tour: the life of a supplier using FLOW

The tour follows one owner through FLOW in the order a business meets it. Stage 1 runs on blank books (`pnpm demo:blank`); every other stage runs on the demo company (`pnpm demo`), whose figures are those of sections 01 and 03. Each stage names the screens, what the owner does and what FLOW does. Buttons and links are in italics.

Video timestamps. Two recordings of build `ed5e0932` (18 Oct 2026), made by `pnpm demo:video`: the submission video (`flow-demo-5min`, 4:22) and the full tour (`flow-full-tour`, 17:31). The chapter lists are in `docs/deliverables/video/README.md`.

1. Setting up the books: full tour 0:16; submission video 0:12
2. The daily view: full tour 2:48; submission video 0:40
3. Documents: full tour 4:06; submission video 3:06 (a contract becomes invoices)
4. Customers: full tour 6:12
5. Deals and negotiation: full tour 6:45; submission video 1:07 (the buyer asks), 1:19 (FLOW decides), 1:40 (the counter is sent), 1:53 (the deal, followed)
6. Money and approvals: full tour 9:34; submission video 2:35 (the owner decides)
7. Time passing: invoices, receipts, a late payment, the cure, reconciliation: full tour 10:19; submission video 2:04, 2:18, 2:52
8. Ask FLOW: full tour 11:52; submission video 3:30
9. What-if and strategy: full tour 13:12
10. Capex: full tour 13:54
11. Records, evidence and security: full tour 15:16 (records and judging), 16:48 (security); submission video 3:58

1. Setting up the books. *Screens:* the landing page, *Set up your books* (`/setup`), Home. *The owner* chooses *Join FLOW now!* and works through six steps: the business and its cash; credit lines and loans (*Fill from an agreement* reads a lender agreement); customers, their repeating contracts and unpaid invoices (*Fill from a*

contract); bills coming up (quick-add payroll, rent, supplier payments, tax); and the limits FLOW will work within. On the review step the owner sees the "First look" at what Home will say and chooses *Sign and open my books*, re-typing the owner token. *FLOW* checks every step on the server, signs the limits as mandate version 1 and opens the books with one logged entry that starts the evidence chain. Home then answers from the owner's own figures.

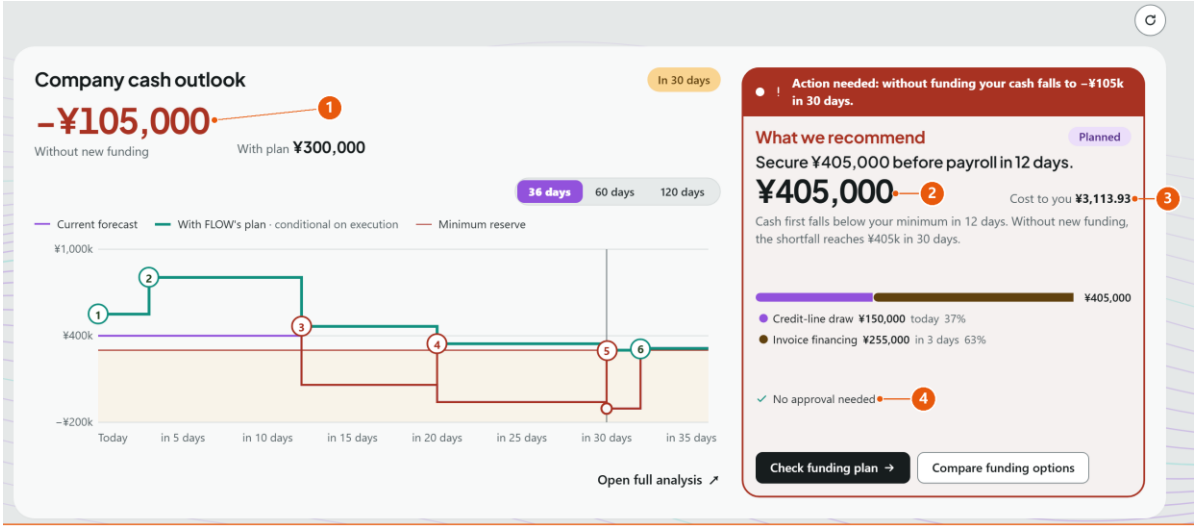


Figure 10. Home on the demo company, day 0: without new funding cash falls to −¥105,000 within 30 days; FLOW recommends securing ¥405,000 before payroll in 12 days, for ¥3,113.93, with no approval needed.

2. The daily view. *Screens:* Home, the header, the account menu. *The owner* reads Home from the top: the cash outlook says the reserve is breached in 12 days, and *What we recommend* covers it for ¥3,113.93 (the credit line ¥150,000 plus invoice financing ¥255,000) inside the signed limits. Below are *Your worklist*, cash available today with the funding ring, upcoming movements and what each customer owes. *FLOW* writes every figure and sentence on the server, in English or Chinese (the account menu switches language), and counts what waits for the owner on the menu's badges. *Show me around* replays the tour of any page, and the header switches between the Business app and the Demo shell.

3. Documents. *Screens:* Attach deals, the document review, Deals. *The owner* drops the Foshan supply agreement, then picks Foshan Home Retail from the list of known companies (or *Add a new customer*). *FLOW* reads it into 18 terms, each beside its quoted clause, and "This deal at a glance" shows the money terms against the forecast. After *Confirm*, the card says what was saved, under which customer, and that the forecast has not changed. Filed under the wrong customer, the same contract cannot be confirmed: FLOW lists the companies it names and offers *File it under Foshan Home Retail Co.* without a new reading. Dongguan's contract reads as one invoice of ¥180,000 every 30 days on 45-day terms; *Set up in my books* shows each figure beside its clause and the forecast now and once the first invoice is issued, and the owner's yes adds it as an owner-only Tier-2 operation that can be undone. A lender agreement is compared with the credit line in the books and can be linked to it.

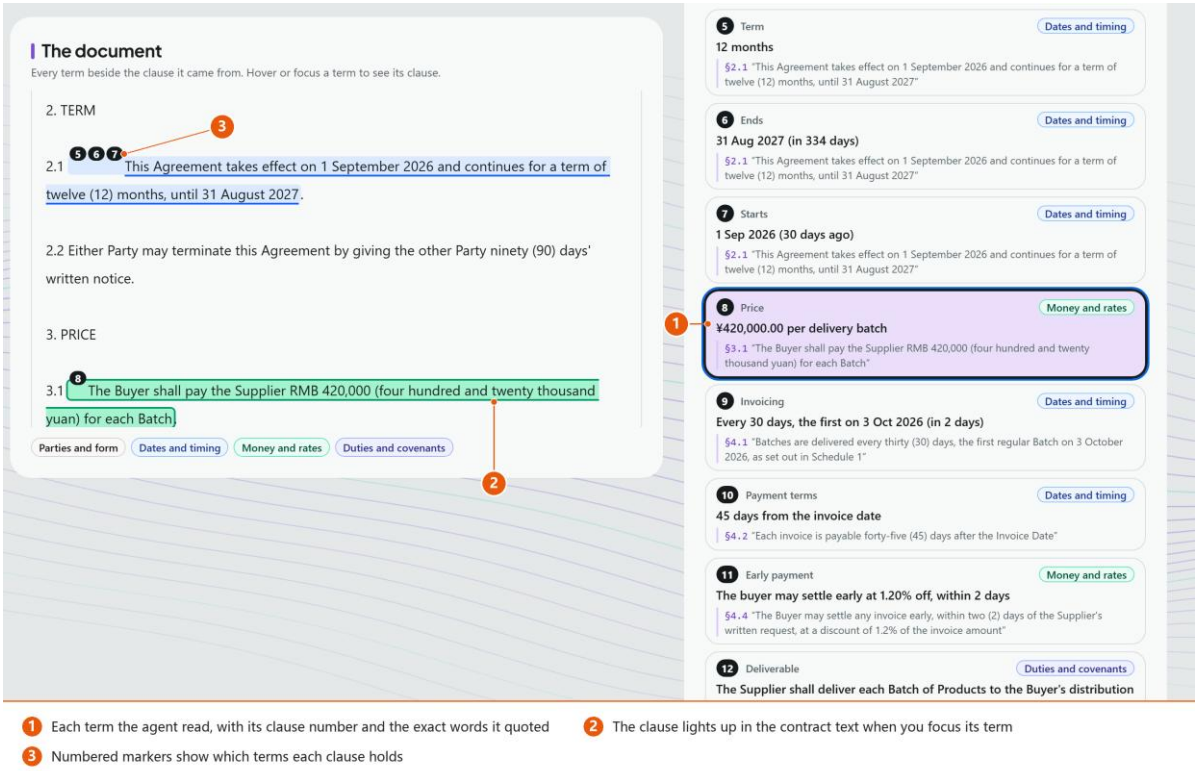


Figure 11. Attach deals: the reading of supply agreement FHR-2026-07. (1) Each term with its clause number and the exact words quoted. (2) The clause lights up when its term is focused. (3) Markers show which terms each clause holds.

4. Customers. *Screens:* a customer's page (`/customers/BUYER-1`), Receivables, Cash & funding. *The owner* opens Foshan Home Retail from its name on Home or Deals. *FLOW* shows what the customer is worth and what is outstanding, the financing linked to its invoices, its share of what the business is owed, how it has paid, its deals and their records, and its exposure: its concentration, and cash with Foshan paying 30 days late, which opens Cash & funding with that stress drawn.

5. Deals and negotiation. *Screens:* Deals (*Buyer messages*, *Your deals*, the deal page, *Your agreements*). *The owner* opens Foshan's WeChat request (60-day terms, a 1.2% early-payment discount and a rebate) and chooses *Check against my limits*. *FLOW* rejects it as asked, for four reasons: ¥28,326.92 of future concessions against a ¥5,000 cap, a reserve breach from day 47, a discount above the 0.88% break-even, and a cost above its own plan. It offers Option A (early payment on up to ¥260,000 at 0.85%, ¥3,035.99) and Option B (55 days with a 0.30% price rise). *Cash impact* shows the business consequences and *Before they ask*. The owner chooses *Review and send the counter*. In the Demo shell the simulated buyer answers at once: *Open to a counter* agrees to Option A in round 1, and *Holds firm* ends in no deal within three rounds with the gap still funded. In Business mode the owner copies FLOW's exact message, sends it, marks it as sent and records the buyer's answer. On the busy books, *Your deals* files six negotiations by who owes the next step, and a request FLOW has no counter for is accepted as asked, or declined, by the owner's click. Once agreed, a deal moves to *Your agreements* with its lifecycle strip and tracker.

6. Money and approvals. *Screens:* Cash & funding, Approvals, *Your limits*. *The owner* reviews the plan, the other plans considered, the forecast at 30, 60 or 120 days and the funding in use, and runs the plan. *FLOW* runs the Tier-1 legs at once and queues anything above the owner's 15% rate ceiling. On Approvals each card states what it does, why it needs the owner and the stored quote; nothing runs until the owner approves, and there is no "approve all". *Your limits* says in plain words what FLOW may do alone, what waits for the owner and what it will never do.

7. Time passing. *Screens:* Demo (operator tools: the clock), Home, Receivables, Approvals, Activity. *The owner* moves the simulated clock. *FLOW* posts each day's scheduled flows, issues recurring invoices and lands funding. On day 2 Foshan pays ¥257,790.00 early, as agreed. On day 34 ¥160,000 is still unpaid and cash is

heading under the reserve: Home and the worklist flag the overdue invoice, Receivables offers a chase message to copy, and FLOW proposes a ¥200,000 advance costing ¥1,782.19. At 32.5% a year it is above the ceiling, so *Queue it for my approval* puts it on Approvals; the owner approves and the cash lands on day 37. The late money arrives on day 36. A payment the owner hears of directly is entered with *Record a payment* on Receivables, and a financed invoice repays its lender first. Activity's *Reconciliation* tab matches each receipt and each promised early payment. FLOW then proposes repaying the drawn credit line, and it warns 7 days before an agreement expires and 14 days before the signed limits do.

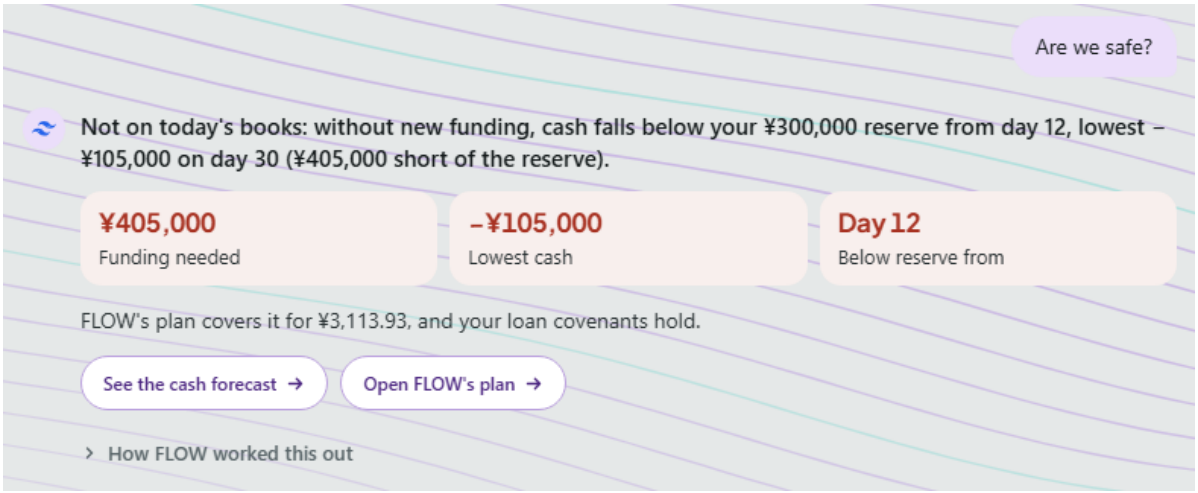


Figure 12. Ask FLOW, day 0: "Are we safe?" The card leads with the answer, shows three key figures (¥405,000 funding needed, −¥105,000 lowest cash, below the reserve from day 12), says what FLOW's plan costs, and links to the forecast and the plan.

8. Ask FLOW. *Screens:* the header's question field, the side panel, the full page (`/ask`), which holds the conversation in one card. *The owner* opens the panel, and FLOW speaks first, naming what needs attention and what fixing it costs. The owner asks "Are we safe?" and gets an answer card (Figure 12); 我们安全吗？ is answered in Chinese, and each link opens the page that shows the answer. "Fund the cash gap" proposes a plan with its operations and cost; *Yes, run it* runs exactly those, and a correction such as "make it 0.8%" amends a pending counter. "Can I pay everyone?" adds the ¥505,000 due in the next 30 days and answers no: cash falls below the reserve from day 12 and below zero from day 20. It offers FLOW's ¥3,113.93 plan, and "go ahead" runs it like the fund-the-gap plan. 账期从 45 天改成 60 天，我该接受吗？ prices the 60 days asked for, not the 45 they replace: ¥24,326.92 of forward concessions for Foshan, above the ¥5,000 limit, so FLOW would counter. When the books do not point at one customer, FLOW asks which one, and the reply "Foshan" answers with the same terms. A queued request is approved by "approve APR-000001", or by "approve it" right after it was shown. "Sign a personal guarantee" is refused for everyone, asked as a question too, and "add a ¥80,000 bill to the forecast" is refused because chat never records facts. *New conversation* starts over.

9. What-if and strategy. *Screens:* the Sandbox, Cash & funding, a deal's *Cash impact*. From Foshan's request the owner chooses *Try other terms*: at 45 days instead of 60 the verdict becomes a counter, and Option A's preset is accepted. Nothing is written. Cash & funding says what ¥10,000 arriving 30 days earlier is worth. *Before they ask* shows how far each lever can go for Foshan, and which packages pass every check, before the buyer asks.

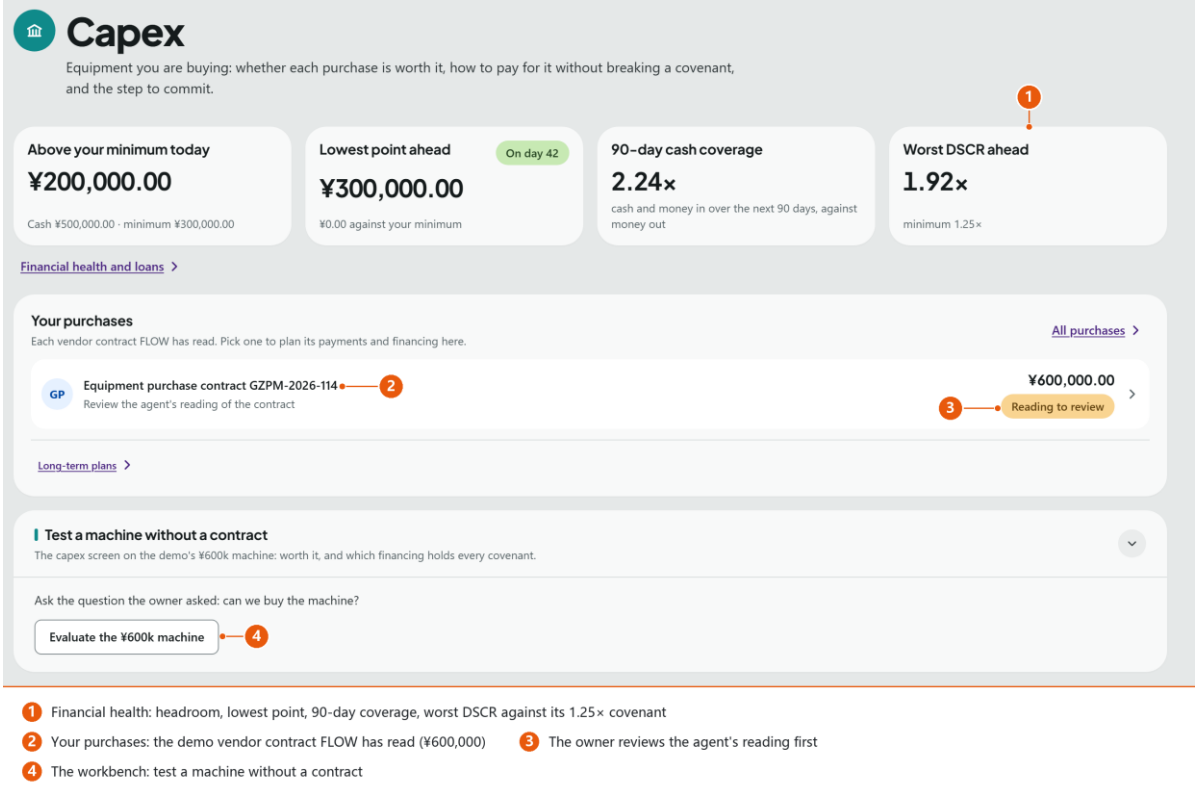


Figure 13. The Capex hub: (1) the financial health figures; (2) the demo vendor contract FLOW has read; (3) the owner reviews the reading first; (4) the workbench to test a machine without a contract.

10. Capex. *Screens:* Capex, the purchase workbench, *Financial health and loans*, *Long-term plans*. *The owner* tests a ¥600,000 machine with *Test a machine without a contract*. *FLOW* screens cash with the line, 18- and 36-month loans and a 48-month lease, and selects the lease (¥92,327.32 of charges). *Apply* queues a Tier-2 application, and *Prepare the borrower file* builds a lender-style file that is never sent. *Read the demo vendor contract* reads a supplier's contract; *Work out the payments* lays out its schedule and prices its early-payment discount; *Commit, paying early* waits on Approvals. *Financial health and loans* shows coverage, ratios, covenant room and four illustrative loans (*Add to my funding menu* queues a Tier-2 addition), and *Long-term plans* ranks projects and structures over 60 months.

11. Records, evidence and security. *Screens:* Activity, *Security and evidence* (`/trust`), the Demo story. *The owner* reads every operation and security event in order, each sealed to the one before it. On the evidence view, *Download JSONL* exports the record, and `python scripts/verify_evidence.py <file>` recomputes the chain with Python's standard library and rejects an edited copy. On the security view, *Run the FastCapital scene* sends a hostile "pre-approved lender" message: the flagged words are shown, nothing is booked, the sender gets FLOW's fixed reply and the harm scoreboard stays at zero. The Demo story replays the negotiation, the late payment and the cure in six scenes, and the owner's approval comes only from the owner's click.